

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Modern History 06 -- Structure of Government and Constitutional Development, 1757-1858 -- Premium Solved PYQ Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

MODERN HISTORY - TOPIC 06

Structure of Government & Constitutional Development, 1757-1858

Regulating Act 1773 to the Government of India Act 1858 | GS-I Modern Indian History | Date: 2026-08-19

FOCUS

1773-1858: Regulating Act, Supreme Court and jurisdiction, Act of Settlement 1781, Pitt's India Act 1784, Act of 1786, Charter Acts 1793/1813/1833/1853, and the Government of India Act 1858.

EXAM MOVE

Prelims: hold Governor-General of Bengal vs India vs Viceroy precisely. Mains: read this as parliamentary control over a corporation, not a liberal reform story.

EVIDENCE

Repository basic/advanced Topic 06; Bipin Chandra's Modern India and Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's From Plassey to Partition; official 2019 and 2023 Prelims papers.

CAUTION

No invented statutory wording, no fabricated PYQ key, no borrowing of Topic 04/07/08/09/11/12 material -- boundaries are held throughout; both PYQs are labelled where unverified.

Original deterministic study visual - Modern History Topic 06

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Modern History 06 -- Structure of Government and Constitutional Development, 1757-1858 -- Premium Solved PYQ Workbook

Transparent PYQ audit and route decision

Audit scope: every Prelims and Mains GS-I/GS-II/CSAT routing ledger and integration-audit file currently in the repository (_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md, PYQ-INTEGRATION-AUDIT-2018-2023.md, PYQ-INTEGRATION-AUDIT-2024-2025.md, PYQ-INTEGRATION-AUDIT-2026.md) was checked line by line for any question mentioning the Regulating Act, the Supreme Court at Calcutta, Nand Kumar, the Amending Act/Act of Settlement, Pitt's India Act, the Board of Control, the Act of 1786, the Charter Acts of 1793/1813/1833/1853, the Governor-General/Viceroy title sequence, or the Government of India Act, 1858.

Audit result: this topic **owns exactly two verified, directly routed Prelims PYQs**, both attributed by the ledgers to Modern-Indian-History/basic/06_Government-Structure-and-Constitutional-Development-1757-1858.md, with no further item found routed here in any checked ledger (2018-2023, 2024-2025 or 2026; Prelims, Mains or CSAT):

1. **2019 Prelims, GS-I, Q4** -- Charter Act of 1813 provisions, solved in full immediately below, marked "Routed; key unavailable locally" in the ledger.
2. **2023 Prelims, GS-I, Q50** -- the Act designating the Governor-General of Bengal as Governor-General of India, solved in full immediately below, also marked "Routed; key unavailable locally."

The companion per-file audits (PYQ-INTEGRATION-AUDIT-2018-2023.md and later years) separately confirm that the advanced/06 file itself carries no additional directly routed question beyond these same two, which are attributed to the basic/06 file. **No further PYQ is claimed for this topic.** Neither question's official answer key exists in any locally held file (confirmed after an exhaustive local search restricted to genuinely available official keys covering 2024, 2025 and 2026 only); both answers below are therefore independently derived from this workbook's own verified statutory evidence and explicitly labelled INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, each with a stated confidence level and full elimination reasoning. Where this workbook's own original MCQs and Mains questions appear below, they are clearly original practice material, not represented as previous UPSC questions.

PYQ 1 solved -- 2019 Prelims, GS-I, Q4 (Charter Act, 1813)

Question (exact, as recovered from local official OCR): "Consider the following statements about 'the Charter Act of 1813':

1. It ended the trade monopoly of the East India Company in India except for trade in tea and trade with China.
2. It asserted the sovereignty of the British Crown over the Indian territories held by the Company.
3. The revenues of India were now controlled by British Parliament.

Which of the statements given above are correct?"

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Official key status: not held locally; a targeted search across every locally available official Civil Services Preliminary Examination 2019 answer-key source was carried out before concluding this, and no locally verifiable official key text was found. The label below therefore applies in full.

INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: **(a) 1 and 2 only.**

Confidence: High.

Elimination reasoning:

- **Statement 1 is TRUE:** the Charter Act of 1813 ended the Company's trade monopoly in India for other British subjects while specifically preserving the Company's exclusive monopoly over tea and all China trade, exactly as this statement describes.
- **Statement 2 is TRUE:** the Act's own language asserted the "undoubted sovereignty of the Crown of the United Kingdom" over the Company's Indian territories, exactly the claim this statement makes.
- **Statement 3 is FALSE:** Indian revenues remained under the Company's own administration throughout this period; the Board of Control (from 1784) supervised and could direct Company policy, but this is political and administrative superintendence, not direct parliamentary control of revenue itself, and no provision of the 1813 Act transferred revenue control to Parliament.
- **Because statement 3 is false,** any option containing it -- (b), (c) and (d) -- is eliminated, leaving only **(a) 1 and 2 only**.

Why this matters for exam technique: this is a bundled multi-statement question testing three genuinely independent claims within a single Act; the safest method is to verify each statement separately against the Act's own three distinct provisions (trade, sovereignty, revenue) rather than forming one undifferentiated impression of "1813 as a reforming Act."

PYQ 2 solved -- 2023 Prelims, GS-I, Q50 (Governor-General designation, Charter Acts)

Question (exact, as recovered from local official OCR): "By which one of the following Acts was the Governor General of Bengal designated as the Governor General of India?"

- (a) The Regulating Act
- (b) The Pitt's India Act
- (c) The Charter Act of 1793
- (d) The Charter Act of 1833

Official key status: not held locally; a targeted search across every locally available official Civil Services Preliminary Examination 2023 answer-key source was carried out before concluding this, and no locally verifiable official key text was found. The label below therefore applies in full.

INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED: **(d) The Charter Act of 1833.**

Confidence: Very high.

Elimination reasoning:

- **Option (a), the Regulating Act (1773), is eliminated:** it created the office of Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal, a Bengal-specific title, with no all-India scope.
- **Option (b), Pitt's India Act (1784), is eliminated:** it reduced the Bengal Council to three members and created the Board of Control in London, but did not touch the Governor-General's own title or create any all-India office.
- **Option (c), the Charter Act of 1793, is eliminated:** it renewed the Company's charter and trade monopoly for twenty years and codified Cornwallis-era regulations, with no title change to the Governor-Generalship.
- **Option (d), the Charter Act of 1833, is correct:** this Act explicitly upgraded the Governor-General of Bengal into the Governor-General of India, the office first held in this all-India form by Lord William Bentinck, exactly matching the question's own wording.

Why this matters for exam technique: a direct "which Act did X" question across four genuinely different Acts rewards keeping a clean office-title ladder (Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal, 1773 -> Governor-General of India, 1833 -> Viceroy, 1858) rather than a vague sense that "some Charter Act" made this change.

Evidence Bank 1 -- Actors and motives (one line each)

Actor	Role / motive
Robert Clive	First Governor of Bengal under Company rule (to 1767); later criticised over patronage/corruption, feeding the 1772-73 crisis anxieties
Warren Hastings	First Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal under the Regulating Act, 1773; central figure in the 1774-76 Council deadlock and the Nand Kumar episode
Philip Francis	Leading figure of the standing 3-1 Council majority (with Clavering and Monson) that outvoted Hastings, 1774-76
Elijah Impey	First Chief Justice of the Supreme Court at Calcutta under the 1774 Charter; a close personal associate of Hastings; presided over Nand Kumar's 1775 trial
Maharaja Nand Kumar	Accused Hastings of corruption before the Council; separately tried on an 1770 forgery charge and executed, 1775 -- treated source-critically, never as settled fact
William Pitt the Younger	British Prime Minister; steered Pitt's India Act, 1784 through Parliament, creating the Board of Control and the Secret Committee
Lord Cornwallis	Governor-General, 1786-93; received the Act of 1786's override power; oversaw the Charter Act, 1793's continuation and codification
Lord William Bentinck	Governor-General of Bengal since 1828; became the first Governor-General of India under the Charter Act, 1833
Thomas Babington Macaulay	First Law Member of the Governor-General's Council under the Charter Act, 1833; chaired the Law Commission; later chaired the 1854 Civil Service (Macaulay) Committee
Lord Canning	Governor-General since 1856; became the first Viceroy under the Government of India Act, 1858

Evidence Bank 2 -- Master date list

Date	Event
1765-72	Diwani grant and the Dual Government (Topic 04; referenced here only as this topic's starting trigger)
1772-73	Company financial crisis, government loan request, parliamentary patronage/accountability debate
1773	Regulating Act
1774	Supreme Court at Calcutta established (1774 Charter); Hastings-Council 3-1 deadlock begins
1775	Nand Kumar trial and execution
1776	Monson's death contingently, non-statutorily, breaks the Council deadlock
1777-79	Patna Case
1779-80	Cossijurah Case
1781	Amending Act (Act of Settlement)
1784	Pitt's India Act; Board of Control and Secret Committee created; Bengal Council reduced to three
1786	Act of 1786; Cornwallis given a direct override power
1793	Charter Act, 1793; twenty-year charter renewal; Cornwallis-era codification continued
1813	Charter Act, 1813; trade monopoly ends except tea/China; Crown sovereignty asserted; missionaries permitted; education grant authorised
1833	Charter Act, 1833; Company's commercial role ends entirely; Governor-General of India created (Bentinck); Law Member and Law Commission created; non-discrimination clause enacted
1853	Charter Act, 1853; no fixed term ("until Parliament shall otherwise provide"); additional legislative members added
1854	Macaulay Committee designs the competitive-examination mechanism for the Indian Civil Service
1855	First competitive examination for the Indian Civil Service actually held
1857-58	Revolt of 1857 (Topic 11; referenced here only as a structural trigger among several for 1858)
1858	Government of India Act, 1858; Company rule, Board of Control and Court of Directors abolished; Secretary of State and Council of India created; Canning becomes first Viceroy
1 Nov 1858	Queen's Proclamation -- a separate political-policy document, not the 1858 Act itself

Evidence Bank 3 -- Key figures and sums (hold loosely, cite as estimates where marked)

- Regulating Act, 1773: Bengal Council of four members total, including the Governor-General -- the design that produced the 1774-76 standing 3-1 majority against Hastings.
- Pitt's India Act, 1784: Bengal Council reduced to three members total (Governor-General plus two), structurally lowering the odds of a standing hostile majority.
- Pitt's India Act, 1784: Board of Control of six members, including the Secretary of State and the Chancellor of the Exchequer -- a different body, at a different date, from the fifteen-member Council of India created only in 1858.
- Charter Act, 1793: renewed the Company's charter and trade monopoly for twenty years, the same fixed-term pattern later repeated in 1813 and 1833, and explicitly broken in 1853.
- Charter Act, 1813: one lakh rupees a year statutorily earmarked for "the revival and promotion of literature and the encouragement of the learned natives of India" and useful scientific knowledge -- a statutory authorisation whose actual disbursement was delayed for years, a matter resolved only by Macaulay's 1835 Minute on Education (Topic 09), not by this topic.

- Government of India Act, 1858: statutory Council of India of fifteen members, with an initial majority of seven having prior East India Company service or directorship experience -- this topic's clearest single "rupture within continuity" marker.
- Charter Act, 1853: added additional legislative members (judges of the Calcutta Supreme Court, and representatives drawn from the Madras, Bombay, Bengal and Agra/North-Western Provinces administrations) to the Governor-General's Council for legislative purposes, distinct from the smaller existing executive Council -- procedural/administrative broadening, not political representation, and no Indian sat on this enlarged Council.

Evidence Bank 4 -- Document and institution distinctions

- **Bengal's Dual Government (1765-72, Topic 04) vs Pitt's India Act's "dual control" (1784 onward):** two entirely distinct institutions, separated by both decade and geography -- the Dual Government split the Nawab's Nizamat from the Company's Diwani inside Bengal; dual control split the Board of Control from the Court of Directors, both sitting in Britain.
- **The Government of India Act, 1858 vs the Queen's Proclamation, 1 November 1858:** the Act is the constitutional-legal transfer instrument (abolishing Company rule, the Board of Control and the Court of Directors; creating the Secretary of State and the Council of India); the Proclamation is the separate political-policy announcement (non-interference in religion, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, qualified amnesty) -- never answer a question about one with content that belongs only to the other.
- **The Patna Case (1777-79) vs the Cossijurah Case (1779-80):** Patna was a personal-law/civil-court jurisdiction clash; Cossijurah was a revenue-administration jurisdiction clash; both are instances of the same underlying Supreme-Court-versus-Company-courts overlap, but they are not the same case and should never be merged.
- **The Amending Act, 1781, vs Pitt's India Act, 1784:** 1781 corrected Supreme Court jurisdiction (official-acts exemption, revenue-matter exclusion, personal-law direction, provincial-appeal routing); 1784 fixed the separate executive-deadlock problem (smaller council, Board of Control) -- never credit 1781 with fixing the Council's own voting deadlock.
- **The 1833 non-discrimination clause vs the 1853/1854/1855 civil-service reform sequence:** 1833 was a formal legal promise with a thin practical outcome for decades; the genuine mechanism for competitive entry arrived only via the 1853 Act's open principle, the 1854 Macaulay Committee's design, and the first actual 1855 examination -- never state that 1833 alone opened the civil service in practice.

Evidence Bank 5 -- Historiography quick-reference

Lens	Associated historian(s)	Core emphasis
Critical political-economy reading	Bipan Chandra	Company financial crisis and parliamentary patronage/accountability anxiety, not humanitarian motive, as intervention's real driver; British fiscal, mercantile and imperial interest as the frame
Administrative/rule-of-law maturation	Not tied to a single named historian in this topic's own sourced material	A genuine, if slow and repeatedly improvised, maturation of accountable, rule-bound governance out of an initially undisciplined trading-company administration
Company-state/corporate-sovereignty improvisation	A recent broad historiographical trend, not attributed here to one named individual	The Company as an unusual hybrid sovereign-and-commercial entity; the 1773-1858 Acts read as a chain of largely ad hoc, crisis-driven institutional fixes, each responding to the failure exposed by the one before it
Free-trade/industrial-capital transition	Not tied to a single named historian in this topic's own sourced material	Connects the 1813 trade opening and the 1833 commercial wind-up to Britain's own domestic shift from mercantilist monopoly toward industrial free trade, driven by manufacturing/mercantile lobbies

These four lenses are complementary emphases on the same eleven Acts, not four mutually exclusive accounts of different events -- a strong Mains answer may use more than one lens on the same Act (for instance, reading 1833 through both the administrative-centralisation lens and the free-trade/industrial-capital lens at once).

Evidence Bank 6 -- Topic-boundary quick-reference

Adjacent theme	Owning topic	This workbook's treatment
Diwani grant, Dual Government, 1765-72	Topic 04	Referenced only as this topic's own starting trigger
Territorial expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs) financed by this governance structure	Topic 05	Not analysed here
Full colonial economic impact, drain of wealth, land revenue systems	Topic 07	Named as forward bridge only
Detailed civil service, police and judiciary structures	Topic 08	Detailed service structure explicitly routed there; only the 1833-1853-1854-1855 reform sequence is covered here
Education and press policy, including the 1835 Minute on Education	Topic 09	Named as forward bridge only; the 1813 education grant's authorisation is covered here, its implementation is not
The Revolt of 1857 in full	Topic 11	Referenced here only as a structural trigger among several for the 1858 Act, never analysed in its own right
Post-1858 councils and Crown administration (Indian Councils Act, 1861, onward)	Topic 12	Named as forward bridge only; this topic's own endpoint is fixed precisely at 1858

Exactly two PYQs are directly routed to Topic 06 across this repository's own ledgers (2018-2026, all Prelims and Mains windows) -- see the full audit immediately above for the complete methodology.

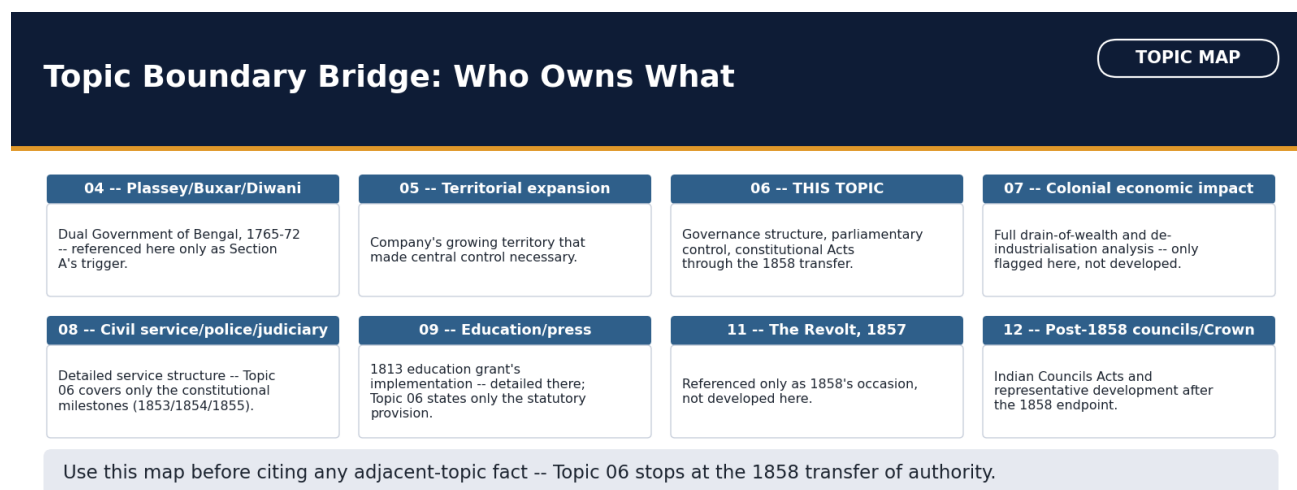


Fig 24. Eight boundary statements, one per adjacent topic.

Visual 24: Repeat: topic-boundary map, previewed before the drills below

Visual 24: Repeat: topic-boundary map, previewed before the drills below. Original deterministic study visual; schematic charts are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Drill 1 -- Name the crisis as fiscal and political, never humanitarian

Claim: State the 1772-73 crisis as Company bankruptcy risk, an emergency government loan, and parliamentary anxiety over unaccountable patronage and mismanagement; never lead with, or imply, a humanitarian motive tied to the 1770 famine as Parliament's primary driver.

Exam move: A question asking "why did Parliament intervene in Company affairs in 1773" is answered with the financial-crisis-and-accountability mechanism first; the famine belongs in the background context, not the causal headline.

Drill 2 -- State the Regulating Act's exact institutional design, not a vague "more control" answer

Claim: Name the Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal, the four-member Council, the narrower Bengal-subordination-of-presidencies wording, the Court of Directors' reporting duty, and the Supreme Court/1774 Charter together as the Act's five components.

Exam move: A statement-based question on the Regulating Act tests these five components independently -- know which specific component each option is really describing before selecting an answer.

Drill 3 -- The Regulating Act failed on Council arithmetic, not personal failure

Claim: Name the 3-1 Hastings-Council split (1774-76) as the structural cause of failure, Monson's 1776 death as the contingent (non-statutory) resolution, and Pitt's India Act's smaller council (1784) as the actual statutory fix.

Exam move: Reject any answer attributing the Regulating Act's failure to Warren Hastings's personal competence alone; the vote-arithmetic mechanism is the examinable cause.

Drill 4 -- Handle Nand Kumar source-critically, never as settled fact

Claim: State the documented facts (the corruption accusation against Hastings, the separate 1770 forgery charge, the 1775 trial and execution, the Hastings-Impey personal closeness) and explicitly flag the "deliberate silencing" reading as a widely held but contested interpretation.

Exam move: A question inviting assessment of the Nand Kumar episode rewards naming the source-critical caution explicitly, not simply retelling the narrative as though the causal link to Hastings were proven.

Drill 5 -- Distinguish the Patna and Cossijurah jurisdictional zones precisely

Claim: Name Patna as a personal-law/civil-court jurisdiction clash and Cossijurah as a revenue-administration jurisdiction clash; state both as instances of the same underlying Supreme-Court-versus-Company-courts overlap.

Exam move: A question on "why was the Amending Act of 1781 needed" is answered by naming both cases and the general overlap they exposed, not by naming only one case.

Drill 6 -- State exactly what the 1781 Act fixed, and exactly what it left untouched

Claim: Name the four precise 1781 corrections (official-acts exemption, revenue-matter exclusion, Hindu/Muslim personal-law direction, provincial-appeal routing) and state explicitly that the Council-deadlock problem was untouched by this Act.

Exam move: Reject any answer crediting the 1781 Act with fixing the executive deadlock; that required 1784's smaller council and 1786's override power, entirely separate fixes.

Drill 7 -- Never conflate Bengal's Dual Government with Britain's dual control

Claim: Name the Bengal Dual Government (1765-72, Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Topic 04) and Pitt's India Act's dual control (1784 onward, Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both in Britain) as two entirely distinct institutions.

Exam move: Any option using the word "dual" in a governance-structure question must be checked against which decade, which location and which two bodies it actually names before selecting it.

Drill 8 -- Route civil-service reform through its exact four-step sequence

Claim: State the sequence precisely: an 1833 formal non-discrimination promise, an 1853 Act ending patronage and opening the competitive principle, an 1854 Macaulay Committee designing the mechanism, and a first 1855 examination operationalising it.

Exam move: Reject any answer that credits 1833 with opening the civil service in practice, or that credits 1853 alone with instantly producing full competitive recruitment; both are promise-versus-practice traps.

Drill 9 -- State the 1813 Charter Act's three provisions as independently verifiable

Claim: Name trade liberalisation (with the tea/China exception), the Crown-sovereignty assertion, and the missionary/education gesture as three separate statutory moves, each checkable on its own.

Exam move: This is this topic's single most heavily tested Act; a Prelims statement-set question should be answered statement by statement against this three-part checklist, never by a single undifferentiated "1813 was a reforming Act" impression.

Drill 10 -- Keep the 1833 Act's two centralisations separate

Claim: Name the executive/titular centralisation (Governor-General of Bengal to Governor-General of India) and the legislative centralisation (all-India law-making power concentrated in the Governor-General-in-Council) as two distinct movements that happen to arrive in the same Act.

Exam move: A question naming "the Act that created the Governor-General of India" tests the titular centralisation specifically; do not answer it by describing the Law Member or Law Commission instead, which are separate provisions of the same Act.

Drill 11 -- The 1858 Act and the Queen's Proclamation are two different documents

Claim: Name the Government of India Act, 1858 as the constitutional-legal transfer instrument (abolishing Company rule, the Board of Control and the Court of Directors, creating the Secretary of State and Council of India) and the Queen's Proclamation of 1 November 1858 as the separate political-policy announcement (non-interference in religion, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, qualified amnesty).

Exam move: A question asking specifically what the 1858 Act itself provided should not be answered with Proclamation content (religious non-interference, amnesty), and vice versa; keep the two documents' content in two separate mental boxes.

Drill 12 -- State 1858 as rupture-in-sovereignty alongside continuity-in-administration

Claim: Name the abolished apex bodies (Company, Board of Control, Court of Directors) alongside the retained or continued elements (the Governor-General's office, now also Viceroy; the 1853-55 civil-service principle; a majority of the new Council of India's first members being ex-Company men) in the same answer.

Exam move: A "how much did 1858 actually change" question rewards naming both halves explicitly -- rupture at the apex, continuity below it -- rather than treating 1858 as either a total revolution or a mere formality.

Drill 13 -- Keep this topic's own endpoint at 1858, not beyond it

Claim: State explicitly that the Indian Councils Act of 1861 and all later representative-council reforms are Topic 12's material, and that the Revolt of 1857's own causes and course are Topic 11's material, referenced here only as this topic's trigger.

Exam move: When a question edges toward post-1858 councils or the Revolt's own detailed narrative, name the boundary explicitly rather than silently absorbing that material as though it belonged to this topic.

Drill 14 -- Never invent a PYQ, an official key, or a topic boundary

Claim: This topic owns exactly two verified, routed Prelims PYQs (2019 GS-I Q4; 2023 GS-I Q50), per the repository's own routing ledger; neither has a locally held official key, so both answers here are explicitly labelled INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED, with elimination reasoning shown in full.

Exam move: Never present either of this topic's two inferred answers as officially confirmed, and never claim a third PYQ for this topic that the ledgers do not themselves show.

Learning MCQs (20; key rotation A -> B -> C -> D, independently re-derived and re-ordered from the learning session)

Correct options are deliberately rotated by actual option placement, not by relabelling: A -> B -> C -> D through the full set. This workbook's own rotation and option order are independently derived from the learning session's version of each question -- the underlying facts are identical, but the position of the correct option, and the order of the distractors, genuinely differ here. Read the explanation after attempting each item.

Q1. By 1765-72, the East India Company in Bengal held which combination of functions simultaneously?

- A. Revenue authority (Diwani), army command, and dispensation of justice through overlapping courts, alongside its original trading-corporation identity
- B. Full Crown-sanctioned sovereignty, formally recognised by Parliament from 1765 itself
- C. Only military command, with revenue and justice remaining entirely with the Nawab
- D. Only a trading privilege, with all governance functions remaining exclusively with the Nawab's own administration

Answer: A. Revenue authority (Diwani), army command, and dispensation of justice through overlapping courts, alongside its original trading-corporation identity

Explanation: This is this topic's own starting fact -- a chartered trading corporation had become, in practice, a territorial sovereign in Bengal, with no British constitutional framework designed for that combination; the other options each remove one of the genuinely simultaneous functions.

Q2. What was the primary driver of Parliament's 1772-73 intervention in Company affairs?

- A. A direct military defeat suffered by Company forces in Bengal
- B. Company financial crisis (a bankruptcy-threatening cash crisis and a Bank of England loan request) combined with parliamentary concern over patronage and accountability
- C. A formal request from the Mughal emperor for British Parliament to intervene
- D. A wave of British public humanitarian concern over the 1770 Bengal famine

Answer: B. Company financial crisis (a bankruptcy-threatening cash crisis and a Bank of England loan request) combined with parliamentary concern over patronage and accountability

Explanation: The famine forms background context, not the causal headline; Parliament's actual trigger was the Company's own solvency crisis and the political-patronage and accountability anxieties this crisis exposed.

Q3. Which of the following correctly describes the Regulating Act, 1773's core executive institution?

- A. A Governor-General of India with an eight-member all-India council
- B. A Viceroy directly appointed by the Crown, with no Council at all
- C. A Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal) with a four-member Council, and presidency governments subordinated to Bengal in specified matters
- D. A Board of Control in London directly administering Bengal

Answer: C. A Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal) with a four-member Council, and presidency governments subordinated to Bengal in specified matters

Explanation: The Regulating Act's institution was explicitly Bengal-specific (Fort William), with a four-member Council and only bounded presidency subordination; the all-India Governor-Generalship arrives only in 1833, and the Board of Control only in 1784.

Q4. Why did the Regulating Act's Bengal Council prove unworkable in 1774-76?

- A. The Company's Court of Directors dissolved the Council directly
- B. Warren Hastings refused to attend Council meetings
- C. The Supreme Court overruled every Council decision
- D. A standing 3-1 majority (Clavering, Monson and Francis against Hastings and Barwell) repeatedly outvoted the Governor-General, a deadlock resolved only contingently by Monson's 1776 death, with a statutory fix arriving only in 1784

Answer: D. A standing 3-1 majority (Clavering, Monson and Francis against Hastings and Barwell) repeatedly outvoted the Governor-General, a deadlock resolved only contingently by Monson's 1776 death, with a statutory fix arriving only in 1784

Explanation: The failure was structural vote-arithmetic, not personal incompetence or judicial overreach; the correct answer names the specific 3-1 split and both the contingent 1776 resolution and the real 1784 statutory fix.

Q5. The 1775 trial and execution of Maharaja Nand Kumar should be treated, in a rigorous answer, as which of the following?

- A. A source-critical case -- Nand Kumar's separate corruption accusation against Hastings, his 1775 forgery trial and execution under English law, and the Hastings-Impey personal closeness are documented facts, while the "deliberate silencing" reading remains a contested, widely held interpretation, not settled fact
- B. A settled instance of proven judicial murder by Hastings and Impey, established beyond dispute
- C. A case with no connection whatsoever to Warren Hastings or the Supreme Court
- D. An entirely fabricated episode with no basis in any historical record

Answer: A. A source-critical case -- Nand Kumar's separate corruption accusation against Hastings, his 1775 forgery trial and execution under English law, and the Hastings-Impey personal closeness are documented facts, while the "deliberate silencing" reading remains a contested, widely held interpretation, not settled fact

Explanation: A precise answer separates the documented facts from the contested causal interpretation, rather than either dismissing the episode or treating the conspiracy theory as proven.

Q6. The Patna Case (1777-79) and the Cossijurah Case (1779-80) both illustrate which underlying structural problem?

- A. A conflict between the Bengal Council and the Board of Control
- B. The Supreme Court's undefined jurisdiction overlapping with the Company's own courts and revenue administration -- Patna in personal-law/civil-court territory, Cossijurah in revenue-administration territory
- C. A dispute purely about the personal conduct of Warren Hastings
- D. A rebellion by zamindars against Company rule

Answer: B. The Supreme Court's undefined jurisdiction overlapping with the Company's own courts and revenue administration -- Patna in personal-law/civil-court territory, Cossijurah in revenue-administration territory

Explanation: Both cases are best read as two angles on the same structural overlap between Supreme Court jurisdiction and Company judicial/revenue authority, which together made the 1781 Amending Act necessary.

Q7. Which of the following was NOT a correction made by the Amending Act (Act of Settlement), 1781?

- A. Excluding revenue-collection matters from the Supreme Court's jurisdiction
- B. Directing that Hindu law apply to Hindus and Muslim law to Muslims in personal-law matters before the Supreme Court
- C. Reducing the Bengal Council from four members to three, ending the 1774-76 style deadlock
- D. Exempting the Governor-General-in-Council's own official acts from Supreme Court jurisdiction

Answer: C. Reducing the Bengal Council from four members to three, ending the 1774-76 style deadlock

Explanation: The 1781 Act corrected Supreme Court jurisdiction only; the Council-size reduction that fixed the executive deadlock is a separate, later provision of Pitt's India Act, 1784.

Q8. Pitt's India Act, 1784's Board of Control was empowered, in the Act's own phrasing, to do what?

- A. Directly govern India in place of the Company's own administration
- B. Appoint the Governor-General without any reference to the Company's Court of Directors
- C. Abolish the Company's Court of Directors outright
- D. "Superintend, direct and control" the Company's civil, military and revenue affairs in India, while the Company's trade monopoly remained intact

Answer: D. "Superintend, direct and control" the Company's civil, military and revenue affairs in India, while the Company's trade monopoly remained intact

Explanation: The Board of Control supervised Company administration from London through this exact statutory phrase, without displacing the Company's own commercial and administrative machinery or ending its trade monopoly, which continued until the Charter Act of 1813 began to open it.

Q9. How did Pitt's India Act, 1784 change the size of the Bengal Council, and with what structural effect?

- A. It reduced the Council from a Governor-General-plus-four to a Governor-General-plus-three, meaning the Governor-General now needed only one ally for a working majority
- B. It abolished the Council entirely, leaving the Governor-General to rule alone
- C. It left the Council's size unchanged but gave the Governor-General a casting vote for the first time
- D. It enlarged the Council to six members, making consensus even harder to reach

Answer: A. It reduced the Council from a Governor-General-plus-four to a Governor-General-plus-three, meaning the Governor-General now needed only one ally for a working majority

Explanation: This smaller council is the direct statutory response to the Regulating Act's 3-1 deadlock problem, reducing (though not eliminating) the odds of a standing hostile majority.

Q10. Which of the following correctly distinguishes Bengal's Dual Government from Pitt's India Act's "dual control"?

- A. Dual control refers only to Bengal's own internal administration after 1784
- B. The Dual Government (1765-72, Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Bengal) and dual control (from 1784, Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both based in Britain) are different institutions, in different decades, located in different places
- C. They are two names for the exact same institution, just at different dates
- D. The Dual Government continued unchanged until 1858, running parallel to dual control

Answer: B. The Dual Government (1765-72, Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Bengal) and dual control (from 1784, Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both based in Britain) are different institutions, in different decades, located in different places

Explanation: This is this topic's single highest-value trap -- conflating the two "dual" structures collapses two decades, two continents and four separate institutions into one confused answer.

Q11. The Act of 1786 gave the Governor-General which specific power?

- A. Unlimited dictatorial authority over all Bengal administration, overriding the Council in every matter
- B. The power to appoint the Board of Control's members directly
- C. A bounded override power against the Council's majority, specifically "in matters of importance affecting safety, peace, or the interests of the Empire," combined for Cornwallis with the Commander-in-Chief's office
- D. The power to dissolve the Supreme Court

Answer: C. A bounded override power against the Council's majority, specifically "in matters of importance affecting safety, peace, or the interests of the Empire," combined for Cornwallis with the Commander-in-Chief's office

Explanation: The 1786 override is precise and matter-specific, not a general grant of unlimited authority; Cornwallis's simultaneous holding of the Commander-in-Chief's office is a separate but related unification of civil-military command.

Q12. What was the Charter Act of 1793's principal distinctive contribution?

- A. Creating the office of Governor-General of India
- B. Ending the Company's trade monopoly entirely
- C. Creating the Board of Control for the first time
- D. Renewing the Company's charter and trade monopoly for twenty years, and codifying Cornwallis-era Bengal regulations into a systematised, translated body of law

Answer: D. Renewing the Company's charter and trade monopoly for twenty years, and codifying Cornwallis-era Bengal regulations into a systematised, translated body of law

Explanation: 1793 is a continuation-and-codification Act; it neither ended the trade monopoly (which happened only partly in 1813) nor created the Board of Control (1784) or the all-India Governor-Generalship (1833).

Q13. Which of the following is a correct statutory provision of the Charter Act, 1813?

- A. It ended the Company's monopoly of trade in India for other British subjects, while preserving the Company's monopoly over tea and China trade specifically
- B. It ended the Company's monopoly over all trade, including tea and China trade, with no exceptions
- C. It abolished the Company's charter outright
- D. It transferred all Indian revenue collection directly to the British Parliament

Answer: A. It ended the Company's monopoly of trade in India for other British subjects, while preserving the Company's monopoly over tea and China trade specifically

Explanation: The tea/China exception is the exact, frequently tested precision point of this provision; the other three options each misstate the Act's actual scope -- claiming no exceptions at all, claiming direct Parliamentary revenue control, and claiming outright charter abolition are all incorrect.

Q14. The Charter Act, 1813 also included which further provision, distinct from the trade provision?

- A. The creation of a Legislative Council with additional members
- B. An assertion of the "undoubted sovereignty of the Crown of the United Kingdom" over the Company's Indian territories, alongside permission for missionaries to enter and preach, and a one-lakh-rupee education grant
- C. The direct abolition of the Company's Court of Directors
- D. The introduction of open competitive examinations for the civil service

Answer: B. An assertion of the "undoubted sovereignty of the Crown of the United Kingdom" over the Company's Indian territories, alongside permission for missionaries to enter and preach, and a one-lakh-rupee education grant

Explanation: These are 1813's other two verifiable provisions; the Court of Directors survived until 1858, the Legislative Council with additional members arrives in 1853, and competitive examinations are an 1853-55 development.

Q15. Which Act designated the Governor-General of Bengal as the Governor-General of India, and who first held the resulting all-India title?

- A. The Government of India Act, 1858; Lord Canning
- B. The Charter Act of 1793; Lord Cornwallis
- C. The Charter Act of 1833; Lord William Bentinck
- D. Pitt's India Act, 1784; Warren Hastings

Answer: C. The Charter Act of 1833; Lord William Bentinck

Explanation: This is directly tested (2023 Prelims GS-I, Q50, subtopic 10); Bentinck, already Governor-General of Bengal, became the first Governor-General of India under this 1833 upgrade -- Canning's 1858 title is the separate,

later Viceroy addition.

Q16. Which two new features did the Charter Act, 1833 add to the Governor-General's Council?

- A. A Secretary of State and a Council of India
- B. A Viceroy and an enlarged Legislative Council with additional members
- C. A Board of Control and a Secret Committee
- D. A fourth, Law Member (first held by Thomas Babington Macaulay) and a Law Commission tasked with codifying Indian law

Answer: D. A fourth, Law Member (first held by Thomas Babington Macaulay) and a Law Commission tasked with codifying Indian law

Explanation: The Law Member and Law Commission are 1833's specific legal-institutional additions; the Secretary of State/Council of India belong to 1858, the Board of Control/Secret Committee to 1784, and the enlarged Legislative Council to 1853.

Q17. The Charter Act of 1833's non-discrimination clause is best understood as which of the following?

- A. A formal promise removing a legal bar to Company office by reason of religion, place of birth, descent or colour, whose practical effect remained extremely limited for decades, since it created no accessible competitive mechanism by itself
- B. A clause that immediately produced large-scale Indian entry into the higher covenanted civil service
- C. A clause specifically limited to only the judicial service
- D. A clause that was never implemented in any form and was formally repealed soon after

Answer: A. A formal promise removing a legal bar to Company office by reason of religion, place of birth, descent or colour, whose practical effect remained extremely limited for decades, since it created no accessible competitive mechanism by itself

Explanation: This is the topic's clearest promise-versus-practice example -- a formal legal bar was removed, but no practical, accessible route existed until the 1853-55 developments, and even then only partially.

Q18. Which of the following correctly describes a structural feature of the Charter Act, 1853?

- A. It fixed a new twenty-year renewal term, like every earlier Charter Act
- B. It enlarged the Governor-General's Council for legislative purposes by adding additional legislative members (including Supreme Court judges and presidency representatives), distinct from the smaller executive Council
- C. It abolished the office of Governor-General
- D. It created the Board of Control for the first time

Answer: B. It enlarged the Governor-General's Council for legislative purposes by adding additional legislative members (including Supreme Court judges and presidency representatives), distinct from the smaller executive Council

Explanation: 1853 uniquely continued Company rule only "until Parliament shall otherwise provide" (no fixed term) and created this first real legislative-executive institutional split; the Board of Control dates to 1784.

Q19. What is the correct four-step sequence of civil-service reform between 1833 and 1855?

- A. 1858 introduced competitive examinations for the first time, replacing the 1833 clause
- B. 1853 alone instantly introduced full, operating competitive recruitment, with no further steps needed
- C. 1833 formal non-discrimination promise -> 1853 Act ends patronage and opens the competitive principle -> 1854 Macaulay Committee designs the mechanism -> 1855 first competitive examination held
- D. 1833 first competitive examination held -> 1853 Act ends the examination -> 1854 patronage restored -> 1855 non-discrimination clause added

Answer: C. 1833 formal non-discrimination promise -> 1853 Act ends patronage and opens the competitive principle -> 1854 Macaulay Committee designs the mechanism -> 1855 first competitive examination held

Explanation: Collapsing this exact four-step, four-year sequence into "1853 alone" is this topic's most common civil-service trap; the detailed service structure itself is routed to Topic 08.

Q20. The Government of India Act, 1858 abolished which three institutions together?

- A. The Regulating Act, the Amending Act, and the Charter Act of 1793
- B. The Governor-General's office, the Diwani, and the Nizamat
- C. The Supreme Court, the Sadar Diwani Adalat, and the Legislative Council
- D. Company rule itself, the Board of Control (created 1784), and the Company's own Court of Directors -- replaced by a Secretary of State for India and a statutory Council of India

Answer: D. Company rule itself, the Board of Control (created 1784), and the Company's own Court of Directors -- replaced by a Secretary of State for India and a statutory Council of India

Explanation: These three apex bodies are precisely what 1858 abolished; the Governor-General's office itself (now also carrying the Viceroy title) was retained, not abolished, and the Supreme Court/Sadar Diwani Adalat/Legislative Council are separate judicial and legislative institutions untouched by this specific provision.

Broad MCQs (44; key rotation A -> B -> C -> D repeated eleven times, independently re-derived and re-ordered from the learning session)

Q21. The 1765 Diwani grant and the Dual Government (1765-72), fully examined in Topic 04, function in Topic 06's own narrative as which of the following?

- A. The trigger -- the structural anomaly (a private corporation holding sovereign revenue, war and justice powers) that made a British constitutional response necessary, without being re-derived here in detail
- B. An episode entirely unrelated to the Regulating Act, 1773
- C. The subject of Topic 06's own most detailed analysis
- D. A development that occurred after, not before, the Regulating Act, 1773

Answer: A. The trigger -- the structural anomaly (a private corporation holding sovereign revenue, war and justice powers) that made a British constitutional response necessary, without being re-derived here in detail

Explanation: Topic 06 deliberately treats 1765-72 only as its own starting trigger, per this topic's own boundary discipline, since the full mechanics belong to Topic 04.

Q22. What specific financial event forced the East India Company to approach the British government in 1772?

- A. A trade embargo imposed by France
- B. A cash crisis threatening the Company's solvency, leading it to request an emergency loan (understood in this topic's own terms as arranged through Bank of England channels)
- C. A currency devaluation ordered by the Mughal emperor
- D. The Company's own gold reserves were seized by the Nawab of Bengal

Answer: B. A cash crisis threatening the Company's solvency, leading it to request an emergency loan (understood in this topic's own terms as arranged through Bank of England channels)

Explanation: This financial emergency, not a humanitarian response to the 1770 famine, is the proximate trigger that brought Company affairs before Parliament in 1772-73.

Q23. How many members sat on the Bengal Council created by the Regulating Act, 1773, including the Governor-General?

- A. Three
- B. Six
- C. Four
- D. Five

Answer: C. Four

Explanation: The Regulating Act created a Governor-General plus a four-member Council (Warren Hastings alongside Barwell, Clavering, Monson and Francis) -- this specific number is precisely what Pitt's India Act reduced in 1784.

Q24. The Regulating Act's language on presidency subordination to Bengal covered which matters?

- A. Only matters of religious administration
- B. Only commercial and trading matters
- C. All administrative matters without any exception whatsoever
- D. War and peace-related matters, subject to a narrower and more ambiguous "except in emergency situations"-type qualification later widened by Pitt's India Act, 1784

Answer: D. War and peace-related matters, subject to a narrower and more ambiguous "except in emergency situations"-type qualification later widened by Pitt's India Act, 1784

Explanation: The Regulating Act's own subordination clause was narrower and more qualified than later provisions; Pitt's India Act clarified and extended presidency subordination to Bengal more broadly.

Q25. Who was appointed the first Governor-General under the Regulating Act, 1773?

- A. Warren Hastings
- B. Lord William Bentinck
- C. Lord Canning
- D. Lord Cornwallis

Answer: A. Warren Hastings

Explanation: Hastings became the first Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal) under the 1773 Act; Cornwallis (1786), Bentinck (1833, first Governor-General of India) and Canning (1858, first Viceroy) hold later, distinct titles.

Q26. Which three Council members formed the standing majority that repeatedly outvoted Warren Hastings between 1774 and 1776?

- A. Nand Kumar, Impey and Barwell
- B. Clavering, Monson and Francis
- C. Macaulay, Bentinck and Metcalfe
- D. Barwell, Impey and Cornwallis

Answer: B. Clavering, Monson and Francis

Explanation: These three named Council members formed the 3-1 majority against Hastings and his sole ally Barwell -- the precise structural mechanism behind the Regulating Act's practical failure.

Q27. What event contingently, though not statutorily, broke the Hastings-Council deadlock in 1776?

- A. The Charter Act of 1793's council reforms
- B. A direct Crown order dismissing Clavering and Francis
- C. Monson's death, restoring Hastings's casting-vote advantage
- D. The passage of the Amending Act

Answer: C. Monson's death, restoring Hastings's casting-vote advantage

Explanation: Monson's 1776 death was a contingent, non-statutory event; the actual statutory fix for this deadlock problem came only with Pitt's India Act's smaller council in 1784.

Q28. Which office, established under the 1774 Charter, gave the Supreme Court at Calcutta its first Chief Justice?

- A. Lord Cornwallis
- B. Warren Hastings himself
- C. Thomas Babington Macaulay
- D. Sir Elijah Impey

Answer: D. Sir Elijah Impey

Explanation: Impey, a close personal associate of Hastings, was the Supreme Court's first Chief Justice under the 1774 Charter -- this personal closeness is central to the source-critical caution around the Nand Kumar episode.

Q29. Why is forgery relevant to understanding the severity of Nand Kumar's 1775 sentence?

- A. Forgery was a capital offence under the English law the Supreme Court applied, though not typically treated as a capital matter under the pre-existing Indian legal practice applied to such matters
- B. Nand Kumar was actually acquitted of the forgery charge
- C. Forgery carried no penalty at all under English law
- D. The forgery charge was later proven to be a British fabrication with no basis in any document

Answer: A. Forgery was a capital offence under the English law the Supreme Court applied, though not typically treated as a capital matter under the pre-existing Indian legal practice applied to such matters

Explanation: This legal-severity mismatch (a capital English-law penalty applied via the new Supreme Court) is part of why the episode remains historically contested, alongside the timing relative to Nand Kumar's own corruption accusation against Hastings.

Q30. The Patna Case (1777-79) specifically involved the Supreme Court asserting jurisdiction over which kind of matter?

- A. A dispute over Company shareholding in London
- B. A property/inheritance dispute already decided by a Company provincial court applying Islamic personal law
- C. A revenue-collection dispute involving a zamindar's debts
- D. A criminal rebellion case

Answer: B. A property/inheritance dispute already decided by a Company provincial court applying Islamic personal law

Explanation: Patna shows the Supreme Court reaching into personal-law/civil-court territory already settled by a Company court; Cossijurah (Q31) shows the parallel revenue-administration version of the same overlap.

Q31. The Cossijurah Case (1779-80) specifically provoked which executive response?

- A. The Supreme Court was permanently abolished
- B. The Company voluntarily submitted to full Supreme Court jurisdiction over all revenue matters
- C. The Governor-General-in-Council threatened armed resistance to the Supreme Court's own process-servers over a zamindar's revenue-related debt matter
- D. Parliament immediately annexed Cossijurah to the Crown

Answer: C. The Governor-General-in-Council threatened armed resistance to the Supreme Court's own process-servers over a zamindar's revenue-related debt matter

Explanation: This sharp executive-judicial confrontation over revenue-administration territory, alongside Patna's personal-law-territory clash, made the 1781 Amending Act's jurisdictional corrections all but inevitable.

Q32. Which matter did the Amending Act of 1781 specifically exclude from the Supreme Court's jurisdiction, routing it instead to the Company's own revenue courts and the Governor-General-in-Council?

- A. Criminal cases involving Europeans
- B. Commercial contract disputes between British merchants
- C. Ecclesiastical disputes
- D. Revenue-collection matters

Answer: D. Revenue-collection matters

Explanation: This is one of the 1781 Act's four precise corrections (alongside the official-acts exemption, the Hindu/Muslim personal-law direction, and provincial-appeal routing) -- directly responding to the Cossijurah-type conflict.

Q33. The Amending Act of 1781 directed the Supreme Court to apply which law in personal-law matters?

- A. Hindu law to Hindus and Muslim law to Muslims, specifically in matters such as marriage, inheritance, caste usage and religious practice
- B. French civil law, following the Chandernagore precedent
- C. English common law uniformly to all litigants regardless of religion
- D. No law at all -- personal-law matters were entirely excluded from any court

Answer: A. Hindu law to Hindus and Muslim law to Muslims, specifically in matters such as marriage, inheritance, caste usage and religious practice

Explanation: This personal-law pluralism direction, examined further as a colonial governance technique in subtopic 14, is a distinct 1781 provision from the revenue-matter exclusion and official-acts exemption.

Q34. How many members composed the Board of Control created by Pitt's India Act, 1784, including a Secretary of State and the Chancellor of the Exchequer?

- A. Nine
- B. Six
- C. Fifteen
- D. Three

Answer: B. Six

Explanation: The six-member Board, including these two senior ministers, gave Parliament its first standing supervisory body over Company administration -- distinct from the fifteen-member Council of India created only in 1858.

Q35. What was the function of the Secret Committee created alongside the Board of Control in 1784?

- A. To try capital criminal cases in Bengal
- B. To supervise missionary activity in India
- C. To provide a channel for the Board's urgent or confidential orders to reach the Company's Court of Directors without full deliberation by the whole Court
- D. To codify Bengal's regulations into a printed body of law

Answer: C. To provide a channel for the Board's urgent or confidential orders to reach the Company's Court of Directors without full deliberation by the whole Court

Explanation: The Secret Committee is a specific administrative mechanism within the 1784 dual-control design, distinct from the Board of Control's own general supervisory power.

Q36. To how many members (including the Governor-General) did Pitt's India Act, 1784 reduce the Bengal Council?

- A. Six
- B. Two
- C. Five
- D. Three

Answer: D. Three

Explanation: This reduction from the Regulating Act's four-member Council structurally lowered the odds of a standing hostile majority, directly answering the 1774-76 deadlock.

Q37. Lord Cornwallis, appointed Governor-General in 1786, combined that office with which other position?

- A. Commander-in-Chief, unifying civil and military command in Bengal for the first time under statute
- B. President of the Court of Directors
- C. Chairman of the Board of Control
- D. Chief Justice of the Supreme Court

Answer: A. Commander-in-Chief, unifying civil and military command in Bengal for the first time under statute

Explanation: This unification, alongside Cornwallis's new bounded override power under the Act of 1786, marks a significant executive-authority consolidation distinct from any judicial or legislative change.

Q38. For how many years did the Charter Act of 1793 renew the East India Company's charter and trade monopoly?

- A. Thirty years
- B. Twenty years
- C. Indefinitely, with no fixed term
- D. Ten years

Answer: B. Twenty years

Explanation: This twenty-year renewal pattern (also seen in 1813 and 1833) is broken only by the Charter Act of 1853, which abandoned a fixed term altogether.

Q39. What was the Charter Act of 1793's specific contribution to Bengal's legal administration?

- A. Establishing the Board of Control
- B. Creating the Supreme Court for the first time
- C. Codifying Cornwallis-era Bengal regulations into a printed, systematised body of law, issued with translations
- D. Introducing competitive examinations for the civil service

Answer: C. Codifying Cornwallis-era Bengal regulations into a printed, systematised body of law, issued with translations

Explanation: This administrative codification is distinct from, and a precursor in spirit to, the more ambitious all-India Law Commission codification effort begun only in 1833.

Q40. What was the size and purpose of the education-related grant introduced by the Charter Act, 1813?

- A. Five lakh rupees, disbursed immediately and fully upon the Act's passage
- B. Ten lakh rupees, for direct construction of English-medium schools
- C. Fifty thousand rupees, for missionary institutions exclusively
- D. One lakh rupees a year, statutorily earmarked for "the revival and promotion of literature and the encouragement of the learned natives of India" and useful scientific knowledge, though actual disbursement was delayed for years

Answer: D. One lakh rupees a year, statutorily earmarked for "the revival and promotion of literature and the encouragement of the learned natives of India" and useful scientific knowledge, though actual disbursement was delayed for years

Explanation: The exact sum and delayed-implementation caveat are both precision points; the dispute over how it was eventually used belongs to Topic 09, resolved only by Macaulay's 1835 Minute on Education.

Q41. The Charter Act of 1813 permitted which group to enter and operate in Company territory, reversing an earlier restrictive practice?

- A. Christian missionaries
- B. French trading companies
- C. Foreign diplomatic missions
- D. Non-Company Indian merchants only

Answer: A. Christian missionaries

Explanation: This permissive missionary provision is a third, separate strand of the 1813 Act, alongside the trade-opening and Crown-sovereignty provisions.

Q42. After the Charter Act of 1833, what was the Company's own legal status regarding trade?

- A. It expanded its commercial activity to compensate for reduced administrative duties
- B. It became a purely administrative, non-commercial body holding its Indian possessions in trust for the Crown, with all commercial activity ended outright
- C. It was permitted to trade freely in India but not with China
- D. It retained a reduced but still active trading role limited to tea and China

Answer: B. It became a purely administrative, non-commercial body holding its Indian possessions in trust for the Crown, with all commercial activity ended outright

Explanation: 1833 is the decisive break from 1813's partial opening -- the Company's commercial identity ends completely here, five decades before its administrative identity itself ends in 1858.

Q43. Lord William Bentinck, already Governor-General of Bengal, became the first holder of which new title under the Charter Act, 1833?

- A. Viceroy of India
- B. Chairman of the Board of Control
- C. Governor-General of India
- D. Secretary of State for India

Answer: C. Governor-General of India

Explanation: This all-India upgrade of the existing Bengal office is a distinct, separately examinable fact from the later 1858 addition of the Viceroy title to the same office.

Q44. What was the specific mandate given to the Law Commission established under the Charter Act, 1833?

- A. To supervise missionary education institutions
- B. To manage the Company's remaining commercial assets
- C. To try Nand Kumar-style forgery cases directly
- D. To examine and codify Indian law into a unified, systematic body of codes, under Macaulay's chairmanship

Answer: D. To examine and codify Indian law into a unified, systematic body of codes, under Macaulay's chairmanship

Explanation: This 1833 mandate set a codification process in motion that produced its major finished codes only after 1858, outside this topic's own 1757-1858 window.

Q45. Which best describes the finished output of the 1833 Law Commission's codification mandate, within this topic's own 1757-1858 window?

- A. The mandate was begun and set in motion in 1833, but its major finished codes were enacted only after 1858, outside this topic's own period
- B. The mandate was abandoned entirely and never produced any code
- C. Full completion of the Indian Penal Code by 1840
- D. The mandate applied only to Bombay and Madras, excluding Bengal

Answer: A. The mandate was begun and set in motion in 1833, but its major finished codes were enacted only after 1858, outside this topic's own period

Explanation: This is an important precision point -- 1833 is this topic's upstream trigger for a downstream codification story, not a completed achievement to credit to 1833 itself.

Q46. The Charter Act of 1833's non-discrimination clause specifically barred disqualification from Company office on which grounds?

- A. Educational qualification alone
- B. Religion, place of birth, descent or colour
- C. Prior criminal record only
- D. Age and gender only

Answer: B. Religion, place of birth, descent or colour

Explanation: This is the clause's exact scope; its practical effect remained thin for decades, since removing a formal bar did not by itself create an accessible competitive mechanism.

Q47. The Charter Act of 1853 continued Company rule under which distinctive condition, unlike the earlier Charter Acts?

- A. Automatic permanent renewal with no possibility of future termination
- B. A conditional renewal subject to a referendum in Bengal
- C. Continuation only "until Parliament shall otherwise provide," with no fixed further term at all
- D. A fixed fifty-year renewal term

Answer: C. Continuation only "until Parliament shall otherwise provide," with no fixed further term at all

Explanation: This open-ended, terminable-at-will phrasing signals Parliament's readiness to end Company rule at any time, functioning as a structural precondition for 1858's comparatively swift transfer.

Q48. Who sat among the additional legislative members added to the Governor-General's Council by the Charter Act, 1853?

- A. Elected Indian representatives from each presidency
- B. Missionaries nominated by the Church of England
- C. Only serving military officers
- D. Judges of the Calcutta Supreme Court and representatives drawn from the Madras, Bombay, Bengal and Agra (North-Western Provinces) administrations

Answer: D. Judges of the Calcutta Supreme Court and representatives drawn from the Madras, Bombay, Bengal and Agra (North-Western Provinces) administrations

Explanation: These were British officials or Company nominees offering regional administrative input, not democratic representation; no Indian sat on this enlarged Council.

Q49. What did the Charter Act of 1853 do to the Company Directors' power over civil-service recruitment?

- A. It ended patronage nomination and opened recruitment to competition in principle, without itself designing or operating an examination system
- B. It strengthened patronage nomination further
- C. It transferred patronage power to the Governor-General personally
- D. It abolished civil-service recruitment altogether

Answer: A. It ended patronage nomination and opened recruitment to competition in principle, without itself designing or operating an examination system

Explanation: The Act's own text did not design the exam system; that required the separate 1854 Macaulay Committee, with the first actual examination held only in 1855.

Q50. What was the specific function of the 1854 Macaulay Committee, distinct from the Charter Act of 1853 itself?

- A. It tried Nand Kumar's forgery case
- B. It designed the syllabus, age limits and administrative rules for competitive civil-service recruitment under the principle the 1853 Act had opened
- C. It negotiated the Treaty of Allahabad
- D. It drafted the Charter Act of 1858

Answer: B. It designed the syllabus, age limits and administrative rules for competitive civil-service recruitment under the principle the 1853 Act had opened

Explanation: This committee is the second of four steps in the 1833-1855 civil-service reform sequence, operationalising the principle the 1853 Act had only opened.

Q51. In which year was the first actual competitive examination held for the Indian Civil Service under the new 1853-54 principle and mechanism?

- A. 1853
- B. 1858
- C. 1855
- D. 1833

Answer: C. 1855

Explanation: This is the fourth and final step of the sequence -- 1833 promise, 1853 Act, 1854 committee, 1855 first examination -- and must never be collapsed into "1853" alone.

Q52. Alongside Company rule itself, which two supervisory bodies did the Government of India Act, 1858 abolish?

- A. The Regulating Act's Council and the Amending Act's provisions
- B. The Legislative Council and the Law Commission
- C. The Supreme Court and the Sadar Diwani Adalat
- D. The Board of Control (created 1784) and the Company's own Court of Directors

Answer: D. The Board of Control (created 1784) and the Company's own Court of Directors

Explanation: These two bodies, both central to the 1784 dual-control design, were replaced by the Secretary of State for India and the statutory Council of India.

Q53. The new office created by the 1858 Act to replace the Board of Control was described in the administrative practice of the period using which phrase?

- A. "Fountain of authority"
- B. "Custodian of the Crown"
- C. "President of the Presidencies"
- D. "Guardian of the Diwani"

Answer: A. "Fountain of authority"

Explanation: This phrase, describing the new Secretary of State for India's centrality, reflects how completely political authority over Indian administration was concentrated in this single Crown minister after 1858.

Q54. How many members composed the statutory Council of India created in 1858, and what proportion had prior East India Company service or directorship experience?

- A. Twenty members, all newly appointed with no Company background whatsoever
- B. Fifteen members, with an initial majority of seven having prior Company service or directorship experience
- C. Six members, matching the earlier Board of Control's size exactly
- D. Ten members, with a minority of two having prior Company experience

Answer: B. Fifteen members, with an initial majority of seven having prior Company service or directorship experience

Explanation: This detail is this topic's clearest single marker of "rupture within continuity" -- apex institutions abolished by name, while a majority of the new Council's first members were themselves drawn from the just-abolished Company machinery.

Q55. Lord Canning, already Governor-General since 1856, became the first holder of which combined title in 1858?

- A. Chairman of the Board of Control
- B. President of the Council of India
- C. Governor-General and Viceroy of India, combined
- D. Secretary of State for India

Answer: C. Governor-General and Viceroy of India, combined

Explanation: The Governor-General's office (created 1833) was retained, not abolished, in 1858; the Viceroy title was added to it, with Canning the first to hold both together.

Q56. Which of the following correctly distinguishes the Government of India Act, 1858 from the Queen's Proclamation of 1 November 1858?

- A. The Proclamation abolished the Company, while the Act announced policy promises
- B. The Act was issued only in India, while the Proclamation was passed only in the British Parliament
- C. They are the same single legal document under two different names
- D. The Act is the constitutional-legal transfer instrument passed by Parliament; the Proclamation is a separate political-policy announcement adding promises of religious non-interference, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, and a qualified amnesty

Answer: D. The Act is the constitutional-legal transfer instrument passed by Parliament; the Proclamation is a separate political-policy announcement adding promises of religious non-interference, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, and a qualified amnesty

Explanation: Conflating these two distinct 1858 instruments into one event is a frequently tested error; their functions (legal-constitutional versus political-declaratory) are genuinely separate.

Q57. Read across all eleven Acts examined in this topic, parliamentary sovereignty over Company governance grows through which correctly stepped sequence?

- A. Reporting duty (1773) -> standing Board of Control (1784) -> Crown-sovereignty assertion (1813) -> fully non-commercial trust-holding Company (1833) -> outright abolition of Company rule (1858)
- B. All steps occurred simultaneously in a single 1773 Act
- C. Abolition of Company rule (1773) -> reporting duty (1784) -> Board of Control (1813)
- D. Crown-sovereignty assertion (1773) -> reporting duty (1858)

Answer: A. Reporting duty (1773) -> standing Board of Control (1784) -> Crown-sovereignty assertion (1813) -> fully non-commercial trust-holding Company (1833) -> outright abolition of Company rule (1858)

Explanation: This is the topic's own parliamentary-sovereignty ladder; direct Crown administration is the last step, not an early one, which is why treating "British control of India" as beginning uniformly at 1757 or 1773 is a chronological error.

Q58. Which pairing correctly keeps this topic's executive-centralisation and legislative-centralisation tracks separate?

- A. Executive centralisation began only in 1858, with no earlier steps
- B. Executive: Governor-General of Bengal (1773) -> smaller Council (1784) -> bounded override (1786) -> Governor-General of India (1833) -> Governor-General-and-Viceroy (1858); Legislative: no distinct body -> all-India legislative monopoly under the Governor-General-in-Council (1833) -> a Council enlarged specifically for legislative business (1853)
- C. Both tracks are identical and interchangeable at every date
- D. The legislative track precedes the executive track by fifty years

Answer: B. Executive: Governor-General of Bengal (1773) -> smaller Council (1784) -> bounded override (1786) -> Governor-General of India (1833) -> Governor-General-and-Viceroy (1858); Legislative: no distinct body -> all-India legislative monopoly under the Governor-General-in-Council (1833) -> a Council enlarged specifically for legislative business (1853)

Explanation: These are two parallel ladders sharing some of the same named Acts as their rungs, but tracking genuinely different institutional movements.

Q59. Across the entire 1757-1858 period examined in this topic, which statement about Indian representation in central legislative or executive bodies is correct?

- A. Indian representation began with the Charter Act of 1833's non-discrimination clause
- B. Indian representation was fully achieved by the Government of India Act, 1858
- C. No Indian individual sat on the Governor-General's Council, the 1853 enlarged Legislative Council, the Board of Control, or the 1858 Council of India
- D. Indians formed a majority on the 1853 Legislative Council

Answer: C. No Indian individual sat on the Governor-General's Council, the 1853 enlarged Legislative Council, the Board of Control, or the 1858 Council of India

Explanation: Formal legal-equality promises (1833) and modest civil-service openings (1853-55) ran alongside total exclusion from any legislative or executive seat throughout this entire period; genuine, if still restricted, Indian representation begins only later, under Topic 12's material.

Q60. The reading that Company financial crisis, parliamentary patronage anxiety and political accountability concerns -- not humanitarian motive -- drove the 1772-73 intervention follows which broad historiographical tradition, as used consistently in this topic's own narrative?

- A. A reading found only in colonial-era official correspondence
- B. A reading that denies any British parliamentary involvement occurred at all
- C. A purely legal-formalist reading with no attention to political economy
- D. A critical political-economy reading, associated with historians such as Bipan Chandra

Answer: D. A critical political-economy reading, associated with historians such as Bipan Chandra

Explanation: This is the lens this topic's own Part I narrative follows explicitly, situating British intervention within Britain's own fiscal, mercantile and imperial interests rather than altruistic motive.

Q61. The historiographical trend describing the East India Company in this period as an unusual hybrid sovereign-and-commercial entity, and reading the 1773-1858 Acts as largely ad hoc, crisis-driven improvisations, is best described as which lens?

- A. The company-state/corporate-sovereignty reading
- B. The free-trade/industrial-capital transition reading
- C. The nationalist political-economy reading
- D. The administrative/rule-of-law maturation reading

Answer: A. The company-state/corporate-sovereignty reading

Explanation: This more recent historiographical trend treats each Act as responding to the specific institutional failure exposed by the one before it, rather than as part of one coherent, pre-planned constitutional design.

Q62. Which historiographical lens connects the Charter Act of 1813's trade opening and the Charter Act of 1833's full commercial wind-up to Britain's own domestic shift from mercantilist monopoly toward industrial free trade?

- A. The company-state/corporate-sovereignty reading
- B. The free-trade/industrial-capital transition reading, emphasising British manufacturing and mercantile lobbying against the Company's chartered privileges
- C. The critical political-economy reading of the 1772-73 crisis specifically
- D. The administrative/rule-of-law maturation reading

Answer: B. The free-trade/industrial-capital transition reading, emphasising British manufacturing and mercantile lobbying against the Company's chartered privileges

Explanation: This reading situates 1813 and 1833 as much within British domestic economic-policy history as within Indian constitutional history.

Q63. Which three-step title ladder correctly traces the Governor-Generalship's evolution across this topic?

- A. Viceroy (1773) -> Governor-General of Bengal (1833) -> Governor-General of India (1858)
- B. Governor-General of India (1784) -> Governor-General of Bengal (1813) -> Viceroy (1833)
- C. Governor-General of Bengal/Fort William (Regulating Act, 1773) -> Governor-General of India (Charter Act, 1833, first held by Bentinck) -> Governor-General who is also Viceroy (Government of India Act, 1858, first held in combination by Canning)
- D. Governor-General of India (1773) -> Governor-General of Bengal (1833) -> Viceroy alone (1858)

Answer: C. Governor-General of Bengal/Fort William (Regulating Act, 1773) -> Governor-General of India (Charter Act, 1833, first held by Bentinck) -> Governor-General who is also Viceroy (Government of India Act, 1858, first held in combination by Canning)

Explanation: This exact three-rung, three-date, three-named-office-holder ladder is this topic's own comparative-synthesis backbone.

Q64. Per this topic's own transparent PYQ audit of the repository's routing ledgers, how many Prelims or Mains questions are directly routed to Modern History Topic 06?

- A. Twelve verified questions across Prelims and Mains combined
- B. Exactly one verified Mains question only
- C. Zero, exactly like Topic 04
- D. Exactly two verified Prelims questions (2019 GS-I Q4 on the Charter Act of 1813; 2023 GS-I Q50 on the Act designating the Governor-General of India), both with locally unavailable official keys

Answer: D. Exactly two verified Prelims questions (2019 GS-I Q4 on the Charter Act of 1813; 2023 GS-I Q50 on the Act designating the Governor-General of India), both with locally unavailable official keys

Explanation: This is the topic's own audited, transparent PYQ count, fully solved in the PYQ audit section above with explicit INFERRED ANSWER labelling for both.

Remedial MCQs (16; targeted at this topic's most common specific errors, independently re-derived and re-ordered from the learning session)

Each item below corrects a real, frequently seen misstatement. Read the flawed student statement, then select the accurate remedial correction.

Q65. A student writes: "The Regulating Act, 1773 created the post of Governor-General of India." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The Regulating Act created the Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal), a Bengal-specific office with no all-India scope; the Governor-General of India title arrives only with the Charter Act of 1833
- B. The Regulating Act created the office of Viceroy, not Governor-General
- C. The statement is entirely correct as written
- D. The Regulating Act applied this title only to Madras, not Bengal

Answer: A. The Regulating Act created the Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal), a Bengal-specific office with no all-India scope; the Governor-General of India title arrives only with the Charter Act of 1833

Explanation: This date-and-title conflation is one of the topic's most common errors and is directly relevant to the 2023 PYQ.

Q66. A student writes: "The Regulating Act failed because Warren Hastings was personally incompetent as an administrator." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is correct; Hastings's incompetence is well documented as the sole cause
- B. The Act failed due to a structural 3-1 Council voting majority (Clavering, Monson, Francis) against Hastings, resolved only contingently by Monson's 1776 death, with the actual statutory fix arriving in Pitt's India Act, 1784
- C. The Act never actually failed in practice
- D. The Act failed because the Supreme Court repeatedly overruled Hastings

Answer: B. The Act failed due to a structural 3-1 Council voting majority (Clavering, Monson, Francis) against Hastings, resolved only contingently by Monson's 1776 death, with the actual statutory fix arriving in Pitt's India Act, 1784

Explanation: This mistakes a structural vote-arithmetic flaw for a personal failing -- name the mechanism, not the personality.

Q67. A student writes: "The Nand Kumar trial and execution prove, beyond any dispute, that Hastings and Impey conspired to murder a whistleblower." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The forgery charge and the corruption accusation against Hastings were the same charge
- B. Nand Kumar was never actually tried by the Supreme Court
- C. The documented facts (Nand Kumar's separate corruption accusation, the 1775 forgery trial and execution, the Hastings-Impey personal closeness) support a widely held but contested interpretation of deliberate silencing; this remains a source-critical question, not a settled fact
- D. The statement is entirely proven and requires no qualification

Answer: C. The documented facts (Nand Kumar's separate corruption accusation, the 1775 forgery trial and execution, the Hastings-Impey personal closeness) support a widely held but contested interpretation of deliberate silencing; this remains a source-critical question, not a settled fact

Explanation: Sensationalising this episode into settled fact, rather than a source-critical question, is a specifically flagged trap in this topic.

Q68. A student writes: "The Amending Act of 1781 fixed the Bengal Council's executive deadlock problem." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is correct; the 1781 Act addressed both problems together
- B. The 1781 Act created the Board of Control
- C. The 1781 Act abolished the Bengal Council entirely
- D. The 1781 Act corrected Supreme Court jurisdiction only (official-acts exemption, revenue-matter exclusion, personal-law direction, provincial-appeal routing); the Council's executive-deadlock problem was fixed separately, by Pitt's India Act's smaller council in 1784 and the Act of 1786's override power

Answer: D. The 1781 Act corrected Supreme Court jurisdiction only (official-acts exemption, revenue-matter exclusion, personal-law direction, provincial-appeal routing); the Council's executive-deadlock problem was fixed separately, by Pitt's India Act's smaller council in 1784 and the Act of 1786's override power

Explanation: Jurisdiction-correction and executive-deadlock-correction are two entirely separate statutory fixes, arriving in different Acts, in different years.

Q69. A student writes: "Pitt's India Act's 1784 'dual control' is the same institution as Bengal's 1765-72 Dual Government." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. These are two entirely distinct institutions -- the Dual Government (Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Bengal, 1765-72, Topic 04) and dual control (Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both based in Britain, from 1784) -- sharing only the loose word "dual"
- B. The Dual Government continued unchanged as part of dual control until 1858
- C. The statement is correct; both refer to the same Board of Control structure
- D. Dual control replaced the Dual Government directly in 1772

Answer: A. These are two entirely distinct institutions -- the Dual Government (Nawab's Nizamat vs Company's Diwani, Bengal, 1765-72, Topic 04) and dual control (Board of Control vs Court of Directors, both based in Britain, from 1784) -- sharing only the loose word "dual"

Explanation: This is this topic's single highest-value trap, spanning different decades, different institutions and different locations.

Q70. A student writes: "The Charter Act of 1793 ended the East India Company's trade monopoly." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The Company never held a trade monopoly at any point
- B. The 1793 Act renewed, rather than ended, the Company's trade monopoly for a further twenty years; the first real opening of Indian trade to non-Company British subjects comes only with the Charter Act of 1813
- C. The statement is correct as written
- D. The Company's trade monopoly was first ended by the Regulating Act of 1773

Answer: B. The 1793 Act renewed, rather than ended, the Company's trade monopoly for a further twenty years; the first real opening of Indian trade to non-Company British subjects comes only with the Charter Act of 1813

Explanation: 1793 is a continuation-and-codification Act, not a liberalising one; the monopoly's partial opening is specifically an 1813 development.

Q71. A student writes: "The Charter Act of 1813 ended the Company's monopoly over all trade, with no exceptions at all." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The exceptions applied only to Bengal, not to Madras or Bombay
- B. The 1813 Act preserved the Company's monopoly over all trade without any change
- C. The 1813 Act ended the Company's trade monopoly in India for other British subjects while specifically preserving the Company's exclusive monopoly over tea and all China trade
- D. The statement is correct; no exceptions existed

Answer: C. The 1813 Act ended the Company's trade monopoly in India for other British subjects while specifically preserving the Company's exclusive monopoly over tea and all China trade

Explanation: The tea/China exception is this Act's single most frequently tested precision point, directly relevant to the 2019 PYQ.

Q72. A student writes: "The 1813 education grant of one lakh rupees was immediately and fully disbursed for Indian education upon the Act's passage." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is correct as written
- B. The grant was disbursed in full within the same year, 1813
- C. The grant was never mentioned in the 1813 Act at all
- D. The grant was a statutory authorisation, not an operating programme; actual disbursement was delayed for years amid the Anglicist-Orientalist dispute, resolved only by Macaulay's 1835 Minute on Education, a matter belonging to Topic 09

Answer: D. The grant was a statutory authorisation, not an operating programme; actual disbursement was delayed for years amid the Anglicist-Orientalist dispute, resolved only by Macaulay's 1835 Minute on Education, a matter belonging to Topic 09

Explanation: A statute's passage does not itself guarantee its stated purpose was instantly realised on the ground -- a recurring pattern across this whole topic.

Q73. A student writes: "The Charter Act of 1833 ended only some of the Company's commercial activities, while allowing limited trade to continue." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The 1833 Act ended all of the Company's remaining commercial and trading activities outright, converting it into a purely administrative body holding its territories in trust for the Crown
- B. Commercial activity ended only in 1858, not in 1833
- C. The statement is correct; limited tea trade continued after 1833
- D. The Company's commercial activity was never affected by any Charter Act

Answer: A. The 1833 Act ended all of the Company's remaining commercial and trading activities outright, converting it into a purely administrative body holding its territories in trust for the Crown

Explanation: 1833 is a complete, not partial, commercial wind-up -- distinct from 1813's only-partial trade opening.

Q74. A student writes: "The 1833 non-discrimination clause immediately opened the higher civil service to large numbers of Indians in practice." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is correct; Indian entry into the covenanted service surged immediately after 1833
- B. The clause removed only a formal legal bar; the number of Indians actually securing entry into the higher covenanted ranks remained extremely small for decades, since no practical, accessible competitive mechanism existed until 1853-55, and even then only partially
- C. The clause applied only to the judicial service, not the wider civil service
- D. The clause was repealed within a year of its passage

Answer: B. The clause removed only a formal legal bar; the number of Indians actually securing entry into the higher covenanted ranks remained extremely small for decades, since no practical, accessible competitive mechanism existed until 1853-55, and even then only partially

Explanation: This is the topic's clearest promise-versus-practice gap -- a formal legal bar removed, but persistent practical barriers remained for a long time afterward.

Q75. A student writes: "The Charter Act of 1853 itself instantly introduced full, operating competitive examinations for the Indian Civil Service." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. No competitive examination was ever held before 1858
- B. The statement is correct as written
- C. The 1853 Act ended patronage nomination and opened the principle of competition only; the 1854 Macaulay Committee designed the actual mechanism, and the first competitive examination was held only in 1855
- D. Competitive examinations were introduced by the Regulating Act of 1773

Answer: C. The 1853 Act ended patronage nomination and opened the principle of competition only; the 1854 Macaulay Committee designed the actual mechanism, and the first competitive examination was held only in 1855

Explanation: Collapsing this exact four-step, four-year sequence into "1853 alone" is one of this topic's most common and heavily flagged traps.

Q76. A student writes: "The Government of India Act, 1858 was caused solely by the Revolt of 1857, with no earlier structural pressure for reform." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The Revolt of 1857 played no role at all in the 1858 Act's timing
- B. The statement is correct; no prior developments are relevant
- C. The 1858 Act was planned in full detail as early as 1773
- D. The Revolt was the immediate, proximate trigger, but structural pressure substantially predates it -- the Charter Act of 1853's own open-ended continuation and seventy-five years of incremental Crown-supervisory centralisation (1784, 1813, 1833) made 1858's transfer a comparatively short constitutional step, not a sudden revolution

Answer: D. The Revolt was the immediate, proximate trigger, but structural pressure substantially predates it -- the Charter Act of 1853's own open-ended continuation and seventy-five years of incremental Crown-supervisory centralisation (1784, 1813, 1833) made 1858's transfer a comparatively short constitutional step, not a sudden revolution

Explanation: This is the same "trigger vs. underlying cause" logic used for the 1772-73 crisis, now applied to this topic's other endpoint.

Q77. A student writes: "The Government of India Act, 1858 and the Queen's Proclamation of 1858 are the same single document." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. They are two distinct instruments -- the Act is the constitutional-legal transfer instrument passed by Parliament; the Proclamation (1 November 1858) is a separate political-policy announcement with its own distinct promises (religious non-interference, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, qualified amnesty)
- B. The Proclamation was issued decades before the Act
- C. The statement is correct; both were issued as one combined text
- D. The Act contains the amnesty provisions, and the Proclamation contains the abolition of the Company

Answer: A. They are two distinct instruments -- the Act is the constitutional-legal transfer instrument passed by Parliament; the Proclamation (1 November 1858) is a separate political-policy announcement with its own distinct promises (religious non-interference, treaty recognition, formal equality before law, qualified amnesty)

Explanation: Conflating these two 1858 instruments into one event is a frequently tested and specifically flagged error.

Q78. A student writes: "The Government of India Act, 1858 abolished the office of Governor-General entirely, replacing it with an entirely new and separate office called Viceroy." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The Viceroy title existed before 1858 and was abolished by the 1858 Act
- B. The Governor-General's office (created 1833) was retained, not abolished; the new Viceroy title was added to and combined with it, with Lord Canning the first to hold both together from 1858
- C. The Governor-General's office was abolished in 1833, not 1858
- D. The statement is correct; the offices were entirely separate and held by different people

Answer: B. The Governor-General's office (created 1833) was retained, not abolished; the new Viceroy title was added to and combined with it, with Lord Canning the first to hold both together from 1858

Explanation: 1858 abolished Company rule, the Board of Control and the Court of Directors -- not the Governor-General's own office, which continued in a combined, expanded form.

Q79. A student writes: "This topic's own coverage includes the Indian Councils Act of 1861 and later representative-council reforms." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is correct; 1861 is this topic's own final Act
- B. The Indian Councils Act of 1861 actually predates the Regulating Act of 1773
- C. This topic's constitutional coverage ends at the 1858 Act and its accompanying Proclamation; the Indian Councils Act of 1861 and later representative reforms belong to Topic 12 (post-1858 councils and Crown administration)
- D. Topic 06 and Topic 12 cover identical, fully overlapping material

Answer: C. This topic's constitutional coverage ends at the 1858 Act and its accompanying Proclamation; the Indian Councils Act of 1861 and later representative reforms belong to Topic 12 (post-1858 councils and Crown administration)

Explanation: Keeping this topic's own endpoint precisely at 1858 is an explicitly stated boundary discipline, matching this topic's own ownership statement.

Q80. A student writes: "Modern History Topic 06 has zero verified PYQs, exactly like Topic 04." What is the correct remedial statement?

- A. The statement is correct; Topic 06 has no routed PYQs at all
- B. Topic 06's PYQs have officially verified answer keys held locally
- C. Topic 06 owns exactly one routed Mains PYQ
- D. Topic 06 owns exactly two verified, routed Prelims PYQs -- 2019 GS-I Q4 (Charter Act of 1813) and 2023 GS-I Q50 (Governor-General of India designation) -- both confirmed via the repository's own routing ledger, each solved above with an explicit INFERRED ANSWER label since no official key exists locally

Answer: D. Topic 06 owns exactly two verified, routed Prelims PYQs -- 2019 GS-I Q4 (Charter Act of 1813) and 2023 GS-I Q50 (Governor-General of India designation) -- both confirmed via the repository's own routing ledger, each solved above with an explicit INFERRED ANSWER label since no official key exists locally

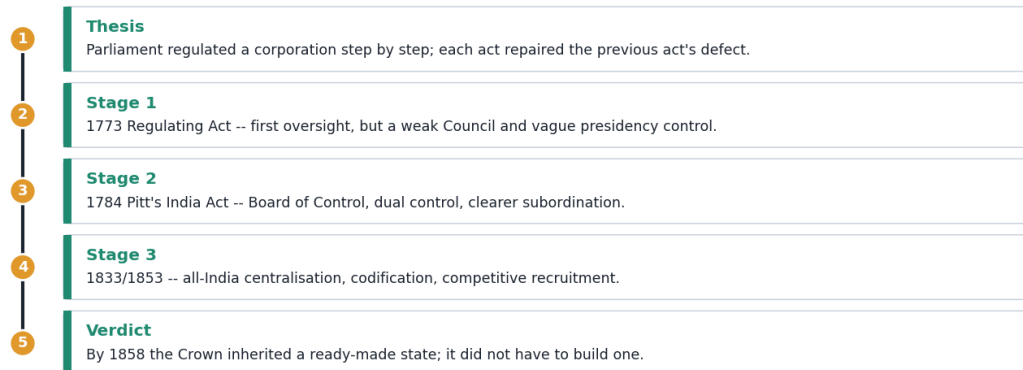
Explanation: Unlike Topic 04 (zero routed PYQs), Topic 06 owns two verified, directly routed Prelims questions -- never invent a PYQ count, and never claim an official key exists where an exhaustive local search found none.

Mains practice: solved model answers

Word limits scale with marks in this package's own convention: 10 marks = 150 words, 15 marks = 250 words, 20 marks = 300 words. The "Directive alignment" and "Why this earns marks" notes are examiner-craft scaffolding around the answer, not part of the counted word limit.

Answer Spine: 10-Mark ('Trace the constitutional ladder')

PRACTICE



Use for a 10-mark 'trace' or 'trajectory' directive -- three acts as stages plus one structural verdict.

Fig 25. Five-step spine for a 10-mark trace/trajectory demand.

Visual 25: Answer spine, 10 marks -- the fiscal-and-patronage case for parliamentary intervention, 1772-73

Visual 25: Answer spine, 10 marks -- the fiscal-and-patronage case for parliamentary intervention, 1772-73. Original deterministic study visual; schematic charts are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Mains 1 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Examine why Parliament's 1772-73 intervention in East India Company affairs is better explained by fiscal crisis and political accountability concerns than by humanitarian motive.

Directive alignment: "Examine" requires identifying the actual causal mechanism behind intervention, not a general narrative of Company misrule.

Introduction: By 1772, the Company's own solvency, not conscience, brought its Indian government before Parliament.

Answer: A cash crisis threatening the Company's solvency forced it to seek an emergency government-backed loan in 1772, exposing to Parliament a private corporation exercising sovereign revenue, war and justice powers over Bengal with no constitutional accountability to the Crown, Parliament, or Bengal's population. Parliamentary debate of the period centred on the Company's mismanagement, the unregulated patronage its Court of Directors controlled, and the political risk of a chartered corporation operating as an unsupervised sovereign, rather than primarily on the 1770 Bengal famine's human cost, which formed background context rather than the intervention's causal headline. The Regulating Act, 1773 that resulted was framed around financial oversight, patronage and accountability provisions.

Qualification: This reading does not deny that famine-related mismanagement featured in contemporary criticism; it denies that humanitarian concern was the primary driver of Parliament's specific 1772-73 legislative response.

Verdict: Fiscal crisis and accountability anxiety, not humanitarian motive, are the defensible primary drivers of the 1773 intervention.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require naming the 1772 cash crisis and loan request specifically, alongside the patronage/accountability concern, while correctly relegating the famine to background context rather than causal headline.

Mains 2 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Distinguish the institutional design of the Regulating Act, 1773 from that of Pitt's India Act, 1784, with particular reference to the size of the Bengal Council.

Directive alignment: "Distinguish" requires a precise, paired before/after comparison, not a general description of either Act alone.

Introduction: The single clearest before/after institutional comparison in this topic is the Bengal Council's own size, and what that size change was meant to fix.

Answer: The Regulating Act, 1773 created a Governor-General of Fort William (Bengal) with a four-member Council, a design that produced a standing 3-1 majority (Clavering, Monson, Francis) against Warren Hastings between 1774 and 1776. Pitt's India Act, 1784 reduced this Council to a Governor-General-plus-three, meaning the Governor-General now needed only one ally, not two, for a working majority, while also creating a standing Board of Control in London -- an institution entirely absent from the 1773 design -- and extending presidency subordination to Bengal more clearly across war, diplomacy and revenue matters together.

Qualification: The smaller council reduced, but did not by itself eliminate, deadlock risk; the Act of 1786 added a further, direct override power the following year.

Verdict: 1784's smaller council and new Board of Control directly answer 1773's specific structural weaknesses.

Why this earns marks: A top answer names the exact council sizes (four vs three) and connects the change causally to the 1774-76 deadlock, rather than describing both Acts in parallel without contrasting them.

Mains 3 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Account for the source-critical problems in treating the 1775 trial and execution of Maharaja Nand Kumar as a settled case of judicial murder.

Directive alignment: "Account for" requires reasoned explanation of why the evidentiary and interpretive basis is contested, not a retelling of the episode.

Introduction: The Nand Kumar episode is a case study in the gap between documented fact and contested interpretation.

Answer: The documented facts are narrow: Nand Kumar had separately accused Warren Hastings of corruption before the Bengal Council; he was then tried before the Supreme Court on an unrelated 1770 forgery charge brought by a private litigant; forgery was a capital offence under the English law the Court applied, though not typically so under the pre-existing Indian legal practice for such matters; he was convicted by Chief Justice Elijah Impey, a close personal associate of Hastings, and executed in 1775. The inference that Hastings and Impey engineered this outcome to silence a corruption accuser rests on circumstantial timing and personal association, not on a causal link proven beyond dispute.

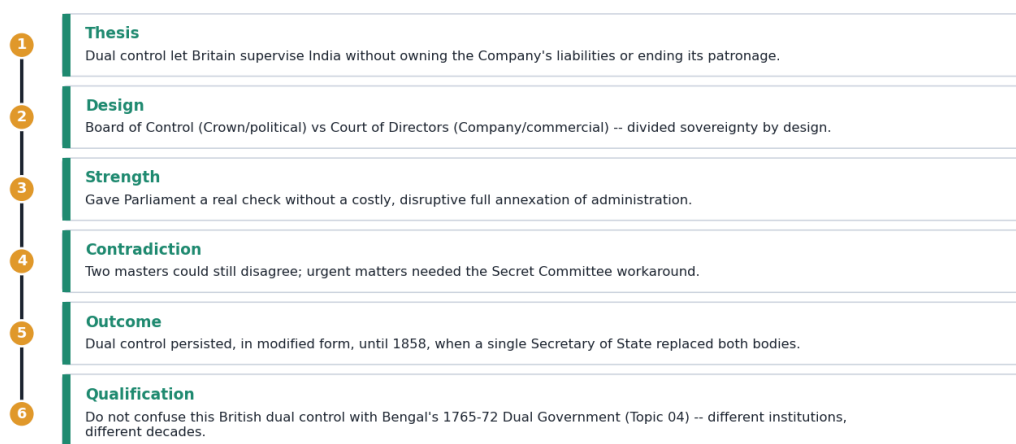
Qualification: This does not require denying the trial's severity or its remarkable timing; it requires refusing to state the conspiracy reading as settled fact.

Verdict: The episode is best presented as documented facts plus a widely held, but contested, interpretation -- not as proven judicial murder.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require naming the separate 1770 forgery charge precisely, the Hastings-Impey closeness, and the explicit source-critical qualification together.

Answer Spine: 15-Mark ('Assess dual control, 1784-1858')

PRACTICE



Use for a 15-mark 'assess/evaluate an institution' directive -- design, strength, contradiction, outcome, qualification.

Fig 26. Six-step spine for a 15-mark institutional-evaluation demand.

Visual 26: Answer spine, 15 marks -- distinguishing jurisdiction-correction from executive-deadlock-correction, 1781 vs 1784

Visual 26: Answer spine, 15 marks -- distinguishing jurisdiction-correction from executive-deadlock-correction, 1781 vs 1784. Original deterministic study visual; schematic charts are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Mains 4 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Discuss the exact corrections made by the Amending Act (Act of Settlement), 1781, and explain why it did not resolve the Regulating Act's own executive-deadlock problem.

Directive alignment: "Discuss... and explain" requires both an itemised account of the 1781 corrections and a causal explanation of their limited scope.

Introduction: The Amending Act of 1781 answered a jurisdictional crisis, not an executive one, and its own precision is best appreciated by naming what it left untouched.

The four 1781 corrections: The Act exempted the Governor-General-in-Council's own official acts, performed in a public capacity, from Supreme Court jurisdiction; excluded revenue-collection matters entirely, routing them to the Company's own revenue courts and to appeal before the Governor-General-in-Council; directed the Supreme Court to apply Hindu law to Hindus and Muslim law to Muslims in personal-law matters; and routed appeals from provincial Company courts to the Governor-General-in-Council or the Sadar Diwani Adalat, not the Supreme Court.

The triggering crises: These corrections responded directly to the Patna Case (1777-79, a personal-law/civil-court jurisdiction clash) and the Cossijurah Case (1779-80, a revenue-administration jurisdiction clash), both exposing the same underlying Supreme-Court-versus-Company-authority overlap.

Why the executive deadlock remained unresolved: The 1781 Act's own scope was jurisdictional, not structural-executive; it made no change to the Bengal Council's size or voting arithmetic, the actual mechanism behind the 1774-76 deadlock. That separate problem was addressed only by Pitt's India Act's three-member council (1784) and the Act of 1786's bounded override power.

Qualification: Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's own assessment captures this precisely: the 1781 Act "defined more precisely the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court, but did not address the other anomalies" in Bengal's government.

Verdict: 1781 is a precise, targeted jurisdictional fix; the executive-deadlock fix is a separate, later statutory story.

Why this earns marks: A top answer lists all four corrections specifically and states explicitly, with named evidence, why the deadlock problem required entirely separate later legislation.

Mains 5 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Evaluate the Charter Act of 1813 as a bundle of three distinct statutory provisions, and explain why this makes it one of this topic's most heavily tested Prelims Acts.

Directive alignment: "Evaluate... and explain" requires both an itemised account of each provision and an examiner-facing explanation of testability.

Introduction: The Charter Act of 1813 bundles three independently verifiable claims into a single statute, which is exactly why it rewards a statement-by-statement reading.

The trade provision: The Act ended the Company's monopoly of trade with India for other British subjects, while specifically preserving the Company's exclusive monopoly over the tea trade and all trade with China -- a precise exception frequently tested as a standalone true/false statement.

The sovereignty provision: The Act asserted, in its own language, the "undoubted sovereignty of the Crown of the United Kingdom" over the Company's Indian territories -- a symbolic-but-real assertion, distinct from any transfer of administrative control, which remained with the Company.

The permissive/funding provision: The Act permitted Christian missionaries to enter and preach in Company territory, and earmarked one lakh rupees a year for education and useful knowledge -- a statutory authorisation whose actual disbursement was delayed for years, resolved only by the 1835 Minute on Education (Topic 09).

Why this makes 1813 heavily tested: Because these three claims are genuinely independent -- one can be true while another is false -- the Act is ideally suited to Prelims statement-based questions (exactly the structure of the 2019 GS-I Q4 PYQ examined in this topic's own PYQ audit), rewarding candidates who verify each claim separately rather than forming one undifferentiated impression of "1813 as a reforming Act."

Qualification: None of these three provisions should be read as instantly, fully implemented on the ground; each is a statutory claim, with its practical unfolding a separate question.

Verdict: 1813's bundled, independently verifiable structure is precisely what makes it this topic's most examination-relevant single Act.

Why this earns marks: A top answer names all three provisions with their exact qualifying details (the tea/China exception; the exact sovereignty phrase; the delayed education-grant disbursement) and explicitly connects this structure to its own testability.

Mains 6 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Discuss the two distinct centralisations -- executive/titular and legislative -- introduced together by the Charter Act of 1833.

Directive alignment: "Discuss" requires separating two genuinely distinct institutional movements that arrive in the same Act, not treating "1833 centralisation" as one undifferentiated fact.

Introduction: The Charter Act of 1833 is this topic's largest single structural leap precisely because it bundles two different kinds of centralisation into one statute.

The executive/titular centralisation: The Act upgraded the Governor-General of Bengal into the Governor-General of India, with Lord William Bentinck, already Governor-General of Bengal, becoming the first holder of this new all-India title -- a change in office and title, not in law-making power itself.

The legislative centralisation: Separately, the Act centralised legislative authority for the whole of British India in the Governor-General-in-Council, correspondingly curtailing the presidency governments' own earlier, more independent rule-making powers, and added a fourth, Law Member (first held by Thomas Babington Macaulay) without executive departmental responsibilities, alongside a Law Commission tasked with codifying Indian law.

Why the two must be kept separate: A question naming "the Act that created the Governor-General of India" (as in the 2023 PYQ examined in this topic's audit) tests the titular centralisation specifically; answering it by describing the Law Member or Law Commission instead conflates two separate provisions of the same Act.

A bounded caveat on codification: The Law Commission's mandate was begun, not completed, in 1833 -- its major finished codes were enacted only after 1858, outside this topic's own period.

Qualification: The Act also ended all Company commercial activity outright, a third, purely economic change running alongside these two centralisations, examined separately in this topic's own institutional-themes subtopic.

Verdict: 1833 is best understood as three simultaneous but analytically separate moves -- titular, legislative and commercial -- bundled in one statute.

Why this earns marks: A top answer keeps all three strands distinct, names Bentinck and Macaulay specifically, and flags the codification-completion caveat.

Mains 7 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: "The Charter Act of 1833's non-discrimination clause was a promise without a mechanism." Discuss this statement with reference to the Charter Act of 1853.

Directive alignment: "Discuss... with reference to" requires testing the quoted claim specifically against the 1853 Act's own provisions.

Introduction: The gap between an 1833 legal promise and an operating mechanism is this topic's clearest case study in promise-versus-practice.

The 1833 promise: The Charter Act of 1833 provided that no Indian subject of the Company was to be disbarred from Company office by reason of religion, place of birth, descent or colour -- a formal, statutory non-discrimination promise.

Why it remained a promise without a mechanism: The clause removed a legal bar without creating any practical route -- no accessible competitive examination, no defined syllabus or venue -- by which Indians could realistically compete for higher covenanted posts; the number of Indians actually entering those ranks in the following decades remained extremely small.

The 1853-55 partial mechanism: The Charter Act of 1853 ended the Directors' patronage-nomination power and opened recruitment to competition in principle, but did not itself design or operate an examination; the 1854 Macaulay Committee designed the syllabus and rules, and the first actual competitive examination was held only in 1855.

Testing the claim's limits: Even this 1853-55 mechanism was only a partial fulfilment -- practical barriers (examination location in Britain, age limits, financial and cultural access) continued to limit Indian entry for a long time afterward, a detailed story properly routed to Topic 08.

Qualification: The statement should not be read as implying 1833 was meaningless; it established the necessary formal-legal precondition without which even the limited 1853-55 mechanism could not have followed.

Verdict: The statement holds precisely: 1833 promised, 1853-55 partially mechanised, and full practical access remained elusive for decades beyond this topic's own endpoint.

Why this earns marks: A top answer names the exact four-step sequence (1833, 1853, 1854, 1855) and explicitly tests, rather than merely restates, the quoted claim.

Mains 8 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Examine the institutional significance of Pitt's India Act, 1784's "dual control," distinguishing it clearly from Bengal's earlier Dual Government (1765-72).

Directive alignment: "Examine... distinguishing it clearly from" demands the comparison be made explicit and structured, not left implicit.

Introduction: These two "dual" structures are separated by a decade, an ocean, and their entire institutional logic, making the distinction itself the examinable content.

Bengal's Dual Government (1765-72, Topic 04): The Company held the Diwani (revenue, civil justice) through its own Naib Diwans, while the Nawab retained only the nominal Nizamat -- a Bengal-based, Indian-facing arrangement examined fully under Topic 04, with this topic treating it only as its own starting trigger.

Pitt's India Act's dual control (from 1784): A Crown-appointed Board of Control of six members (including the Secretary of State and Chancellor of the Exchequer), empowered to "superintend, direct and control" Company affairs, operated alongside the Company's own Court of Directors, which retained patronage and day-to-day commercial administration -- both bodies based in Britain, supervising Indian governance from London.

The institutional significance of dual control: This design let Parliament supervise Indian governance politically without nationalising Company assets or assuming direct fiscal liability, while the Company's trade monopoly remained fully intact in exchange for accepting this new political superintendence -- a durable compromise that lasted, with later Charter Act modifications, until 1858.

The distinguishing test: Different decades (1765-72 vs 1784 onward), different locations (Bengal vs Britain), and different institutional pairs (Nawab/Company vs Board of Control/Court of Directors) -- sharing only the word "dual."

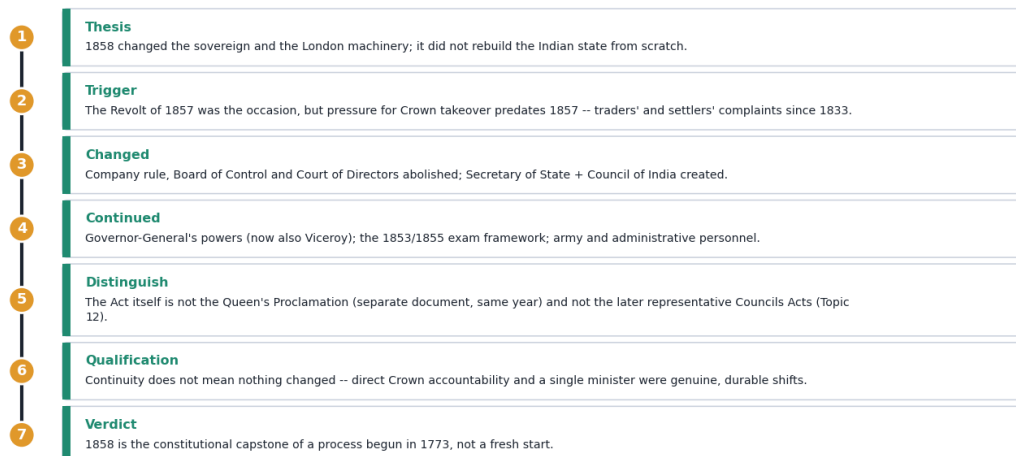
Qualification: Neither structure should be described as an equal partnership; both concentrated substantive power on one side while preserving a nominal or patronage-based role for the other.

Verdict: Dual control is a distinct, later, Britain-based supervisory compromise, not a continuation or renaming of Bengal's earlier Dual Government.

Why this earns marks: A top answer names both structures' exact institutional composition and states the decade/location/institution-pair distinction explicitly, rather than merely asserting they differ.

Answer Spine: 20-Mark ('1858 as endpoint -- change or continuity?')

PRACTICE



Use for a 20-mark synthesis/endpoint directive -- thesis, trigger, changed, continued, distinguish, qualify, verdict.

Fig 27. Seven-step spine for a 20-mark synthesis/endpoint demand.

Visual 27: Answer spine, 20 marks -- 1858 as rupture-in-sovereignty alongside continuity-in-administration

Visual 27: Answer spine, 20 marks -- 1858 as rupture-in-sovereignty alongside continuity-in-administration. Original deterministic study visual; schematic charts are NOT TO SCALE where marked.

Mains 9 - 20 marks | 300 words

Question: "The Government of India Act, 1858 represented more continuation than change." Critically examine this characterisation with reference to the institutions it abolished and the institutions it retained.

Directive alignment: "Critically examine" requires testing the statement against named evidence on both sides, not simply illustrating it.

Introduction: Read against its own text, the 1858 Act supports this characterisation only if "continuation" is measured at the administrative level while "change" is conceded fully at the level of ultimate sovereignty.

The case for change: The Act abolished Company rule outright, together with the Board of Control (1784) and the Company's own Court of Directors, replacing them with a Secretary of State for India -- a Cabinet-level minister directly responsible to Parliament, described in period administrative practice as the "fountain of authority" -- assisted by a statutory Council of India. Sovereignty over India passed decisively and directly to the Crown, ending even the Company's residual legal personality as a governing authority.

The case for continuation: Seven of the fifteen initial Council of India members had prior Company service or directorship experience; the Governor-General's office (created 1833) continued, with Lord Canning, already

Governor-General since 1856, simply adding the Viceroy title in 1858; the 1853-55 competitive-examination principle for civil recruitment continued unaltered; and the bulk of serving administrative and military personnel carried on in place. A period assessment holds that 1858 "meant more continuation than change" in day-to-day administrative practice, and Thomas Metcalf's characterisation of a post-1858 "new attitude of caution and conservatism" supports a similarly gradualist reading.

Weighing the two: The rupture is real and total at the apex (legal sovereignty, named institutions abolished); the continuity is real and substantial below it (personnel, mechanisms, office-holders).

Qualification: "More continuation than change" should not be read as denying the 1858 Act's constitutional significance; it is a claim about administrative practice, not about legal sovereignty, where the change was total.

Verdict: The characterisation is defensible precisely because it operates at the administrative level; at the sovereignty level, 1858 is unambiguously a rupture.

Why this earns marks: A top answer keeps the sovereignty-level rupture and the administrative-level continuity analytically distinct, citing named evidence (Board of Control, Court of Directors, Council of India's ex-Company majority, Canning) for each.

Mains 10 - 20 marks | 300 words

Question: Trace the evolution of the Governor-General's office from 1773 to 1858, and examine the institutional significance of each stage.

Directive alignment: "Trace... and examine" requires a staged chronological account paired with an explanation of why each stage mattered institutionally.

Introduction: The Governor-Generalship's own title changes are a compact, three-rung ladder that tracks this topic's entire executive-centralisation story.

Stage one -- Governor-General of Fort William/Bengal (1773): The Regulating Act created this Bengal-specific office, with Warren Hastings its first holder, subordinate to a four-member Council whose 3-1 voting arithmetic (Clavering, Monson, Francis against Hastings) produced the 1774-76 deadlock -- the office's own authority was, at this stage, structurally weak against its Council.

Stage two -- a strengthened Bengal office (1784-86): Pitt's India Act reduced the Council to three members, easing the majority-formation problem, and the Act of 1786 gave the Governor-General a bounded override power "in matters of importance affecting safety, peace, or the interests of the Empire," with Cornwallis also holding the Commander-in-Chief's office -- a genuine strengthening, though still bounded to Bengal and to specified matters.

Stage three -- Governor-General of India (1833): The Charter Act of 1833 upgraded the office to an all-India title, with Lord William Bentinck its first holder, paired with the centralisation of legislative authority for all British India in the Governor-General-in-Council -- the office's scope now extended well beyond Bengal for the first time.

Stage four -- Governor-General and Viceroy (1858): The Government of India Act, 1858 retained this office while adding the Viceroy title, with Lord Canning, already Governor-General since 1856, the first to hold both together, now representing the Crown directly rather than a still-intact Company.

Institutional significance across the sequence: Each stage answers a specific prior weakness -- Council arithmetic (1784), executive deadlock (1786), fragmented presidency authority (1833), and Company intermediation itself (1858) -- making the office steadily more central, more empowered, and eventually a direct Crown appointment.

Qualification: This ladder should not be read as a smoothly pre-planned design; each stage responded to a specific crisis exposed by the one before it.

Verdict: The Governor-Generalship's evolution is this topic's clearest single institutional through-line, from a weak Bengal office to a Crown Viceroyalty.

Why this earns marks: Full marks require all four named stages, their dates, their first office-holders, and the specific institutional problem each stage answered.

Mains 11 - 20 marks | 300 words

Question: "Constitutional reform in colonial India between 1773 and 1858 was a story of parliamentary sovereignty steadily displacing corporate autonomy." Critically evaluate this statement with reference to at least four named Acts.

Directive alignment: "Critically evaluate... with reference to" requires testing the displacement claim against named evidence, not merely narrating the Acts in sequence.

Introduction: Read across the Regulating Act, Pitt's India Act, the Charter Act of 1833 and the Government of India Act, 1858, the statement holds as a description of direction, though "steadily" requires qualification against this topic's own uneven pace of change.

Testing the claim with named evidence: The Regulating Act, 1773 gave Parliament only a reporting duty from the Company's Court of Directors -- corporate autonomy remained largely intact. Pitt's India Act, 1784 created a standing Board of Control empowered to "superintend, direct and control" Company affairs -- a first real assertion of parliamentary supervisory sovereignty, though the Company's trade monopoly and administrative machinery remained its own. The Charter Act of 1833 ended all Company commercial activity outright, converting it into a purely administrative trust-holder for the Crown -- corporate autonomy now reduced to administrative execution alone. The Government of India Act, 1858 abolished Company rule, the Board of Control and the Court of Directors together, completing the displacement with direct Crown sovereignty.

Testing "steadily": The pace was distinctly uneven -- long stretches of limited change (1793's mere renewal-and-codification) punctuated by sharp steps (1784, 1833, 1858), each typically triggered by a specific crisis (Council deadlock, jurisdictional conflict, fiscal pressure, the Revolt of 1857) rather than by continuous, gradual pressure.

A continuity qualification: Even 1858's completion retained substantial administrative continuity -- a majority of the new Council of India's first members were former Company men, and the 1853-55 civil-service principle continued unaltered -- so "displacement" is most accurate at the level of ultimate sovereignty, not of administrative personnel or method.

Qualification: The statement's implicit teleology (as if 1858 were always the designed endpoint) should be tempered by the company-state historiographical reading, which treats each Act as an improvised response to its own preceding crisis.

Verdict: The statement is substantially correct on displacement of ultimate authority, provided "steadily" is read as crisis-punctuated rather than smoothly continuous.

Why this earns marks: A top answer names at least four Acts with their specific provisions, and separately tests both "displacing corporate autonomy" and "steadily" rather than treating the quotation as a single, indivisible claim.

Mains 12 - 20 marks | 300 words

Question: Evaluate the civil-service reform sequence between 1833 and 1855 as a case study in the gap between formal promise and practical implementation in colonial governance.

Directive alignment: "Evaluate... as a case study" requires assessing the sequence's significance as an illustration of a general pattern, not merely reciting its four steps.

Introduction: Few sequences in this topic illustrate the promise-practice gap as precisely, and as measurably across dated steps, as civil-service reform between 1833 and 1855.

The four-step sequence itself: The Charter Act of 1833 promised, in its own non-discrimination clause, that no Indian subject would be barred from Company office by reason of religion, place of birth, descent or colour. The Charter Act of 1853 ended the Directors' patronage-nomination power and opened recruitment to competition in principle, without designing any examination mechanism itself. The 1854 Macaulay Committee then designed the syllabus, age limits and administrative rules. The first actual competitive examination under this new principle was held only in 1855.

Evaluating the gap at each stage: Between 1833 and 1853, the promise operated with no mechanism at all -- a purely formal-legal removal of disqualification, producing an extremely small practical increase in Indian entry to the higher covenanted ranks. Between 1853 and 1855, the principle existed in statute before any operating mechanism existed, a full two-year design lag. Even after 1855, further practical barriers (examination location, age limits, financial

and cultural access) continued to limit real Indian participation for a long time afterward, a story properly routed to Topic 08.

Why this matters as a case study: This sequence demonstrates, with unusually precise dating, a general pattern found elsewhere in this topic -- the 1813 education grant's delayed disbursement, and the 1858 Act's sovereignty-versus-administration gap are structurally similar promise-practice stories -- making civil-service reform a compact, teachable model of how colonial governance repeatedly authorised more than it operationalised.

Qualification: This should not be read as implying deliberate bad faith at each step; institutional design lags (as with the 1854 committee) are a normal feature of implementing any newly opened principle, not necessarily evidence of insincerity.

Verdict: The 1833-1855 sequence is this topic's clearest, most precisely dated case study in the general colonial pattern of formal promise outrunning practical mechanism.

Why this earns marks: A top answer states all four dated steps precisely, assesses the gap at each transition specifically, and connects the pattern outward to at least one other comparable promise-practice example in this topic.